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CATALOGUE
OF THE
RETROSPECTIVE NOAN EXHIBITION
OF
EUROPEAN TAPESTRIES
HELD IN THE
SAN FRANCISCO MUSEUM OF ART
MCMXXII

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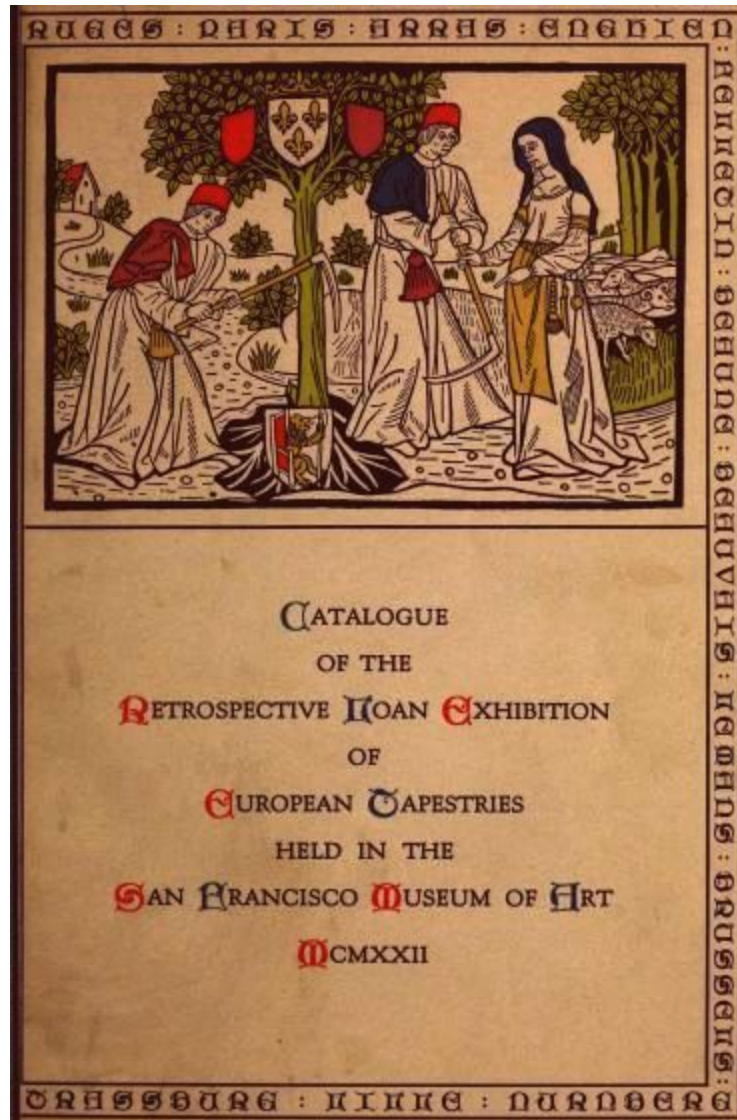
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OF THE RETROSPECTIVE LOAN EXHIBITION OF EUROPEAN
TAPESTRIES ***



EUROPEAN TAPESTRIES

SAN FRANCISCO MUSEUM OF ART

CATALOGUE

OF THE

RETROSPECTIVE LOAN EXHIBITION

OF

EUROPEAN TAPESTRIES

BY

PHYLLIS ACKERMAN

M.A.; PH.D.

WITH A PREFACE BY
J. NILSEN LAURVIK
DIRECTOR

SAN FRANCISCO
PUBLISHED BY THE MUSEUM
MCMXXII

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Printed by TAYLOR & TAYLOR, San Francisco. In the making of the type-design for the cover, the printer has introduced an illuminated fifteenth-century woodcut by an unknown master. Its original appears, illuminated as shown, in "L'Istoire de la Destruction de Troye la Grant," a book printed at Paris, dated May 12, 1484, of which only a single copy is known to exist, that in the Royal Library at Dresden, this

reproduction having been made from the excellent facsimile of the block shown in Claudin's "Histoire de l'Imprimerie en France." The border-design of the cover is composed of the names of the chief tapestry-producing cities in Europe during the Gothic and Renaissance periods.

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PREFACE

This historical exhibition of European Tapestries is the fourth in a series of retrospective exhibitions which we have planned to illustrate the chronological development of some important phase of world-art, as in the Old Masters Exhibition, held in the fall of 1920, or of the art of an individual in whose work is significantly reflected the spirit of his age, as in the J. Pierpont Morgan Collection of drawings and etchings by Rembrandt, exhibited here in the spring of 1920.

In its scope and general lines this exhibition follows closely the plan of our Exhibition of Paintings by Old Masters, and, as will at once be apparent from the subject-matter and treatment, covers the same period of European history. Although important exhibitions of European tapestries have been held at various times both here and abroad, it has remained for our museum to arrange the first complete historical survey of this art given in America. This collection presents in unbroken sequence the main currents influential in the development and decadence of the great art of tapestry-weaving in Europe, from the XIVth century down to and including the early XIXth century, as exhibited in the work of the foremost designers and weavers of the period, in examples that, for the most part, are brilliantly typical and always characteristic of their particular style.

Virtually, every loom of importance in France, Flanders, Germany, Switzerland, Spain, England, and Russia is here represented by historically famous pieces which run the entire gamut of subjects that engaged the interest of the most celebrated designers and weavers of each epoch, from allegorical, classical, historical, and mythological to genre subjects, landscapes, religious pieces, and even portraits and still-life subjects. The only omissions of any consequence are the Italian looms and Soho, and the output of these was relatively small and the examples extant are very scarce. However, their absence does not materially affect the historical integrity of the exhibition as a whole. On the other hand, the Gothic series is perhaps the most complete assemblage of all the most important types

ever brought together at one time in this country, and every important type of Renaissance design is here included; the collection comprises two of the excessively rare products of the Fontainebleau ateliers, as well as unusually fine specimens of the relatively scarce examples of the Spanish and Russian looms.

My chief concern in organizing this exhibition has been to make it exemplify, first, the history of tapestry, and, second, its æsthetic qualities as these have appeared during the different periods of its changing and varying development, which, like the art of painting, had its naïve, primitive beginnings, its glorious culmination, and its decline. Therefore, every piece has been selected both to represent a distinct and significant type in the chronology of the art and to illustrate the artistic merits of that type, and all the tapestries shown are of the highest worth in their particular category and many of them are among the supreme masterpieces of European art, considered from whatever point of view one may choose to regard them. Only too long have these noble products of the loom been relegated to a secondary place in the history of European culture, which they did so much to celebrate. I sincerely trust that this exhibition, culled from seventeen collections in New York, San Francisco, and Paris, may successfully contribute something toward abolishing the hypnotic spell of the gold-framed oil-painting, that artistic fetish which too long has held the uncritical enthralled to the exclusion of other and oftentimes more authentic manifestations of the human spirit in art.

Regarded from the standpoint of design alone, the extraordinary co-ordination of color and pattern (not to speak of the depth and richness of the inner content) exhibited in certain of these pieces is a sharp challenge to the oft-repeated distinction drawn between the major and the minor arts, and one is constrained, after studying these tapestries, to conclude that there are no major or minor arts, only major and minor artists, and that greatness transfigures the material to the point of art, be it paint or potter's clay, and a simple Tanagra transcends in worth all the gilded and bejeweled banalities of Cellini, whose essentially flamboyant soul sought refuge in gold and precious stones. This truth, too rarely insisted upon, is of prime importance in any consideration of art, whether it be "fine" or applied art, and a collection such as this should do much to make it clear. Here one may observe how the principles of design and color that animate the immortal

masterpieces of mural painting are identical with those that give life and vitality to these masterpieces of the loom, and thereby apprehend something of that mysterious law governing the operation of the creative impulse which finds its expression in all the arts, irrespective of time and place, whether it be in rugs, porcelains, Persian tiles and manuscripts, in European primitives, or in the works of Chinese and Japanese old masters, transcending racial differences and attaining a universal affinity that makes a Holbein one with a Chinese ancestral portrait. Surely such opulent fantasy of design and color as is revealed in Nos. 1, 3, 5, and 17, to mention only four of the Gothic pieces in the collection, is deserving of something better than the left-handed compliment of a comparison with painting.

In their masterly filling of the allotted space, in the fine subordination of the varied details to the general effect, as well as in the loftiness and intensity of the emotion expressed, these glorious products of the loom are worthy exemplars of the highest ideals of mural decoration no less than of the aristocratic art of tapestry-weaving. Reflections such as these are the natural consequence of a comparative study of art, and these and kindred reasons are the impelling causes prompting one to exhibit, not only tapestries, but rugs and textiles of all kinds, in an art museum and to give them the same serious study one would accord a Leonardo, a Giotto, a Rembrandt. Aesthetically and racially, they are no less revealing and frequently more interesting in that they are the products of the earliest expressions of those æsthetic impulses the manifestation of which has come to be called art; nor are they less authentic and expressive because communicated with the force and directness of the primitive loom, which give to all its products a certain character and worth rarely equaled by the more sophisticated products of the so-called fine arts.

It is our hope that this catalogue will serve as a helpful guide to all those wishing to make such use of this collection. Every serious student of the subject no less than every unbiased specialist will, I am sure, appreciate at its true worth the scholarly work done by Dr. Ackerman, whose researches have made such a text possible. Bringing to the task a critical judgment and a scientific method of analysis hitherto applied almost exclusively to the identification and interpretation of primitive paintings, the author has been able to correct several well-established errors and to throw new light on

many doubtful and obscure points which are so well documented as should make them contributions of permanent value to the literature of the subject.

In conclusion we wish to thank Messrs. William Baumgarten & Company, C. Templeton Crocker, Demotte, Duveen Brothers, P. W. French & Company, A. J. Halow, Jacques Seligmann & Company, Dikran K. Kelekian, Frank Partridge, Inc., W. & J. Sloane, William C. Van Antwerp, Wildenstein & Company, and Mesdames James Creelman, William H. Crocker, Daniel C. Jackling, and Maison Jamarin of Paris, for their kindness in lending us these priceless examples of the European weavers' art that constitute this notable assemblage of tapestries, and to record our deep appreciation of the generous co-operation of the patrons and patronesses whose sponsorship has made the exhibition possible by guaranteeing the very considerable expense involved in bringing the collection to San Francisco. And last, but not least, we wish to express our grateful appreciation of the unremitting thought and attention devoted by the printer to designing and executing the very fitting typographical form that contributes so largely to making the varied material contained herein readily available to the reader, and to acknowledge, on behalf of the author, the friendly help of Arthur Upham Pope, whose suggestions and criticisms have been found of real value in the preparation of the text of the catalogue.

J. NILSEN LAURVIK, Director

San Francisco, September 29, 1922.

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INTRODUCTION

AN HISTORICAL AND CRITICAL SURVEY

OF THE ART OF TAPESTRY

WEAVING



Tapestry is a compound art. It stands at the meeting-point of three other arts, and so is beset by the problems of all three. In the first place, it is illustrative, for while there are tapestries that show only a sprinkling of flowers, a conventionalized landscape, or an armorial shield, the finest and most typical pieces are those with *personnages* that represent some episode from history, myth, or romance, or give a glimpse of the current usages of daily life. In the second place, tapestry is a mural decoration. It is part of the architectural setting of the rooms, really one with the wall. And, in the third place, it is a woven material—a solid fabric of wool or silk in the simplest of all techniques.

Since a tapestry is an illustration, it must be realistic and convincing, accurate in details and clearly indicative of the story. Because it is also a wall decoration, it cannot be too realistic, but must be structural in feeling and design, and the details must fall into broad masses that carry a strong effect from a distance. And since it is a woven material, even if it be structural, it must be flexible, and must have a fullness of ornament that will enrich the whole surface so that none of it will fall to the level of mere cloth.

But if the tapestry designer have a difficult problem in resolving these conflicting demands of the different aspects of his art, he has also wider opportunities to realize within those limitations. As an illustration, if he

handle it with skill, he can make the design convey all the fascination of romance and narrative. As a mural decoration his design can attain a dignity and noble reserve denied to smaller illustrations, splendid in itself, and valuable for counterbalancing the disproportionate literary interest that the subject sometimes arouses. And the thick material, with its soft, uneven surface, lends, even to a trivial design, a richness and mellowness that the painter can achieve only in the greatest moments of his work.

The designer of tapestry can steer his way among the difficulties of the three phases of his art, and win the advantages of them all only if he have a fine and sensitive feeling for the qualities that he must seek. A realism flattened to the requirement of mural decoration and formalized to the needs of the technique of weaving, that still retains the informality and charm of the illustration, can best be won by considering the design as a pattern of silhouettes; for a silhouette is flat, and so does not violate the structural flatness of the wall by bulging out in high modeling. Moreover, it does give a broad, strong effect that can carry across a large room. And, finally, it permits both of adaptation in attitude and gesture to the needs of the story and of easy-flowing lines that can reshape themselves to the changing folds of a textile. So, to make good silhouettes, the figures in a good tapestry design will be arranged in the widest, largest planes possible, as they are in a fine Greek relief, and they will be outlined with clear, decisive, continuous lines, definitive of character, expressive and vivacious.

The strength and vivacity of the outline is of prime significance in tapestry design, even though in its final effect it appears not primarily as a linear art, but rather as a color art. The outlines have to be both clearly drawn in the cartoon and forcefully presented in the weave; for they bear the burden both of the illustrative expressiveness and of the decorative definition. If they are weakened in delineation or submerged by the glow of the colors, the tapestry becomes confused in import, weak in emphasis, and blurred in all its relations, while the charm and interest of detail is quite lost. The too heavy lines of some of the primitive tapestries are less a defect than the too delicate lines of the later pieces designed by those who were primarily painters, and which were too much adapted to the painting technique. The outlines in the best tapestries are not only indicated with a good deal of force, but these lines themselves have unflagging energy, unambiguous direction, diversified movement, and unfaltering control.

In order to complete and establish the silhouette effect, the color in the best tapestries is laid on in broad flat areas, each containing only a limited number of tones. A gradual transition of tone through many shades is undesirable, because such modulations convey an impression of relief modeling, which is inappropriate and superfluous in an art of silhouette. Then, again, these gradations at a little distance tend to fuse, and thus somewhat blur the force and purity of the color; and, finally, a considerable number of color transitions are ill-adapted to the character of a textile, as they tend to make it appear too much like painting. Nor are fluctuating tones and minute value-gradations necessary for a soft and varied effect. The very quality of tapestry material accomplishes that—first, because the ribbed surface breaks up the flatness of any color area and gives it shimmering variations of light and shade, and, second, because the wide folds natural to the material throw the flat tones now into dark and now into light, thus by direct light and shade differentiating values that in the dyes themselves are identical. Color in tapestry can thus be used in purer, more saturated masses than in any form of painting, not excepting even the greatest murals.

Flat silhouetted figures cannot of course be set in a three-dimensional world. They would not fit. So the landscape, too, must be flattened out into artificially simplified stages. This is also necessary both for the architectural and the decorative effect of tapestry, for otherwise the remote vistas tend to give the effect of holes in the wall, and the distance, dimmed by atmosphere, is too pallid and empty to be interesting as textile design. Yet the fact of perspective cannot be altogether denied. Often the designer can avoid or limit the problem by cutting off the farther views with a close screen of trees and buildings, and this has also the advantage of giving a strong backdrop against which the figures stand out firm and clear. But there are occasions in which a wider field is essential for the purposes of illustration. The problem is how to show a stretch of country and still keep it flat and full of detail. In the most skillful periods of tapestry design the difficulty was met by reducing the perspective to three or four sharply stepped levels of distance, laid one above the other in informal horizontal strips. Aerial perspective was disregarded, each strip being filled with details, all sharply drawn but diminishing in size. The scene was thus kept relatively flat, was adapted to flat figures, and was also filled with interesting details.

This fullness of detail is important in tapestries and is the source of much of their richness and charm. The great periods of weaving made lavish use of an amazing variety of incidents and effects: the pattern of a gown, jewels, the chasing or relief on a piece of armor, bits of decorative architecture, carved furniture, and the numerous household utensils, quaint in shape or suddenly vivid in color—all these, with the innumerable flowers, the veritable menagerie of beasts, real and imaginary, gayly patterned birds, as well as rivers, groves, and mountains, make up the properties with which the designer fills his spaces and creates a composition of inexhaustible resource and delight.

So with flat figures, strong outlines, deep, pure, and simple colors, a flattened setting, and a wealth of details, the artist can make a tapestry that will be at the same time both a representative and an expressive illustration, an architectural wall decoration, and a sumptuous piece of material. But even then he has not solved every difficulty; for the tapestry cannot be merely beautiful in itself. It has to serve as a background for a room and for the lives lived in it; so it must be consonant in color and line quality with the furniture current at the time it is made, and it must meet the prevailing interests of the people. Moreover, while it must be rich enough to absorb the loitering attention, it must also have sufficient repose and reserve and aloofness not to intrude unbidden into the eye and not to be too wearily exciting—and this last was sometimes no easy problem to solve when the designer was bidden to illustrate a rapidly moving and dramatic tale. Sometimes, in truth, he did not solve it, but sometimes he employed with subtle skill the device of so dispersing his major points of action that until they are examined carefully they merge into a general mass effect.

While the designers have at different periods met these various problems in different ways and with varying skill, the technique of the weaving has never been modified to any extent. For centuries this simple kind of weaving has been done. In essentials it is the same as that used in the most primitive kind of cloth manufacture. The warps are stretched on a frame that may rest horizontally or stand upright. The shuttle full of thread of the desired color is passed over and under the alternate warps, the return reversing the order, now under the warps where it was before over, and over where it was under. A comb is used to push the wefts thus woven close together so that they entirely cover the warps. In the finished tapestry the

warps run horizontally across the design. A change of colors in the weft-threads creates the pattern. In the more complex patterns of later works the weaver follows the design drawn in outline on his warps, or sometimes, in the horizontal looms, follows the pattern drawn on a paper laid under his warps so that he looks down through them. His color cues he takes from the fully painted cartoon suspended somewhere near in easy view. Occasionally, in later pieces, to enrich the effect, the simple tapestry weave is supplemented with another technique, such as brocading (cf. No. 52), but this is rare.

All the earliest examples left to us of this kind of weaving are akin to tapestry as we usually know it only in technique. They have practically no bearing on the development of its design. Of the very earliest we have no evidence left by which to judge. Homer, the Bible, and a number of Latin authors all mention textiles that probably could be classed as tapestries; but the references are too general to give us any definite clue as to the treatment of the design. But from the VIth to the VIIIth century, the Copts in Egypt produced many pieces, showing, usually in very small scale, birds and animals and foliage, and even groups of people. Of these we have many samples left. From various parts of Europe, primarily from Germany, in the next two centuries we have a few famous examples. But these are almost wholly without significant relation to the central development of tapestry design. Tapestry, in our sense of the word, begins, as far as extant examples are concerned, with the XIVth century.

From the XIVth to the end of the XVth century was the Gothic period. Then tapestry was at its greatest height. More of the requisites of its design were met, and met more adequately and more naturally, than by any subsequent school of designers or any looms. As illustration, the tapestry of the Gothic period is interesting, vivid, and provocative. The stories and episodes that it presents were, to be sure, all part of the mental content of the audience, so that they comprehended them more immediately than we; but even without the literary background we follow them readily, so adequate is their delineation. Moreover, they carry successfully almost every narrative mood—humor, romance, lyricism, excitement, pathos, and pure adventure—and, except in the traditional religious scenes, they wisely eschew such tense dramatic attitudes as a momentous climax, long-sustained suspense, or profound tragedy. Finally, when they had a good tale to tell, the Gothic

designers rendered their episodes with a fullness of incident and a vivacity of detail never again equaled.

As mural decorations, too, the Gothic tapestries are equally successful. For the figures are always flat and, even while natural and animated, are often slightly formalized and structural in drawing (cf. No. 10); the outlines are clean and active, the colors strong and broad, the vistas either eliminated as in the millefleurs (cf. No. 11) or completely simplified (cf. No. 13), while the details are abundant and delightful. Finally, they are among the most sumptuous textiles ever woven in the Western World—sumptuous, not because of costly material, for they only rarely use metal thread, and even silk is unusual, but sumptuous because of the variety and magnificence of their designs and the splendor and opulence of their color.

Thus the Gothic designers both appreciated and employed to the full all of the æsthetic conditions of their art; yet they did not do this from any theoretical comprehension of the medium. The supremacy of Gothic tapestry rests on a broad basis. It is the final product of one of the most vital and creative epochs in the history of art; its designers were brought up in a great tradition, surrounded everywhere by the most magnificent architectural monuments, accustomed to the habit of beauty in small as well as great things, still inspired and nourished by the fertile spirit that had created and triumphantly solved so many problems in the field of art. A passion for perfection and an elevated and sophisticated taste animated all of the crafts, of which tapestry was but one. The full flowering of tapestry is contemporaneous with that of Limoges enamel, paralleling it in many ways, even to the employment of the same designers (cf. No. 7). Great armor was being made at the same time—armor that exemplified as never before or since its inherent qualities and possibilities: perfection of form and finish, a sensitive and expressive surface, and exquisite decoration logically developed out of construction. Furniture also achieved at that time a combination of strength with natural and imaginative embellishments that still defies copy, while the first publishers were producing the most beautiful books that have ever been printed, unsurpassable in the clear and decorative silhouette of the type, in the perfection of tone, and in the balanced spacing of the composition. Other textile arts, such as that of velvet and brocade weaving, reached the utmost heights of subtlety and magnificence. This easy achievement of masterpieces in kindred fields, so

characteristic of great epochs, doubtless stimulated tapestry-weaving as it did every other art.

This great achievement of the Gothic period in so many fields of art was the natural flowering of the spirit of the time. Life for all was limited in content, education as we understand it meager and ill-diffused, opportunities for advancement for the individual about non-existent. Despite these limitations—partly, indeed, because of them—and despite the physical disorders of the age, there were, none the less, a simplicity and unity of mind and an integrity of spirit that provided the basis for great achievement. The spontaneous and tremendous energy, the inexhaustible fertility that was an inheritance from their Frankish and Germanic forbears were now moulded and controlled by common institutions, by the acceptance of common points of view and the consciousness of unified and fundamental principles of life, the acceptance of an authoritative social system that defined and limited each man's ambitions. All these factors prevented the protracted self-analysis, the aimless criticism, the uncertainties and confusion of individual aims that consume our energies, detract from our will, and impoverish our accomplishments. Theirs was in no sense an ambiguous age; they were conscious of a universal spirit, continuously pressing for expression in art which could fortunately forge straight ahead to objective embodiment.

The stimulation of all of the arts had come in part, too, from the inrush of culture from the Byzantine Empire, where traditions and riches had been heaping up continuously ever since the Greek civilization had at its height spilled over into the East. Every flood-tide of culture is created by various streams of ideas and customs that have for generations taken separate courses. All competent ethnologists are agreed that, no matter what the native equipment of a people is, no matter how abundant are their natural resources, how friendly and encouraging is their environment or how threatening and stimulating, one stream of culture flowing alone never rises to great heights. Invention, evolved organization, and artistic production come only with the meeting and mingling of ideas and habits. The East had first fertilized European intellectual creativeness when the numerous Crusades and the sacking of Constantinople by the Franks brought a wealth of novel and exciting ideas into France and the neighboring territories in the XIth and XIIth centuries. There followed the great period of cathedral-

building with all the minor accompanying artistic developments of the sculpture, the glass-painting, the manuscript illuminating, the enameling, the lyrics of Southern France, and the romances and fabliaux of Northern. This tide was ebbing slowly when a second rush from the East incident to the fall of Constantinople in 1453 lifted it again. The art of tapestry was especially sensitive to this second Byzantine influence. The industry was coming to its height; the demand was already prodigious, the prices paid enormous, the workers highly skilled and well organized. Tapestry was ready to assimilate any relevant contribution. It enthusiastically took unto itself the sumptuous luxury of the decadent Orient with its splendid fabrics, encrusted architecture, complex patterns, and heavy glowing colors. The simple Frankish spirit of the earlier pieces (cf. No. 2) was almost submerged by the riotously extravagant opulence of the East (cf. Nos. 17, 18). On the other hand, too, from the jewelry of Scandinavia, a remote descendant of an ancient Oriental precedent, tapestry adopted examples of heavy richness of design. And at the same time it took also from the Byzantine some of the formality, the thickness of elaborate drapery, the conventionalization of types, and the rigidity of drawing that had paralyzed the art of Byzantium, but that in tapestry enhanced the architectural character and so constituted a real addition. The tendency of the late XIVth century to an absorption in an exact naturalism which might have immediately rushed French and Flemish taste into the scientific realism of the Florentine Renaissance was checked and deflected by the example and the memory of the stiff carven form, the arrested gestures, and the fixed draperies of the mosaics and manuscript illuminations of the Eastern Empire (cf. No. 8).

But aside from these general considerations, which were vital for the creation of great tapestries, there was at work a specific principle perhaps even more important. The manner of treatment which the tapestry medium itself calls for was one which was native to the mind of the time and which declared itself in a great variety of forms.



In the first place, the Middle Ages were in spirit narrative. The bulk of their literature was narrative—long historical or romantic poems with endless sequences of continued episodes that never came to any dominating climax. Their drama, too, was narrative, a story recounted through a number of scenes that could be cut short at almost any point or could be carried on indefinitely without destroying the structure, because there was no inclusive unity in them, no returning of the theme on itself such as distinguishes Greek drama or Shakespeare and which we demand in modern times. Their religion and their ethics also were narrative, dependent, for the common man, upon the life history of sacred individuals that both explained the fundamental truths of the universe and set models for moral behavior. And they were supplemented, too, by profane histories with moralizing symbolism contrived to point the way to the good life, such as we find in the *Roman de la Rose* (cf. No. 4). Even their lesser ethics, their etiquette, was narrative, derived from the fabric of chivalric romance. And, again, their greatest art, their architecture, was adorned with narrative, ornamented with multiple histories, so that even the capital of a column told a tale. The whole world about them was narrative, so that the painters and designers must needs think in narrative terms, and hence as illustrators. The narrative features of the other arts also lent them valuable examples for their

tapestries. Most of their renderings of religious stories were taken direct from the Mystery Plays (cf. No. 14), and some of their scenes were already familiar to them in stained glass and church sculptures.

Moreover, narrative decorations were interesting and important to the people of the XVth century because they had only very limited resources for intellectual entertainment. Books were scarce, but even if plentiful would have been of little use, for very few could read. The theatre for the mass of the people was limited to occasional productions on church holidays of Mystery and Miracle plays, and even for the great dukes these were only meagerly supplemented by court entertainers. There was no illustrated daily news, no moving pictures, no circuses, no menageries, no easy travel to offer ready recreation. In our distractedly crowded life today we are apt to forget how limited were the lives of our ancestors and what pleasure, as a result, they could get from a woven story on their walls.

In the second place, the Gothic designers, when they came to draw their decorative illustrations, because of their inherited traditions, naturally fell into a technique adapted to the architectural forms of mural decoration. For all the art of the Middle Ages was the derivative of architecture, and at its inception was controlled by it. The original conception of the graphic arts in this period was the delineation on a flat surface of sculpture—sculpture, moreover, that was basically structural, because made as part of a building. So the painted figures were heavily outlined silhouettes in a few broad planes with the poise and the restraint essential to sculpture. These early statuesque figures, familiar in the primitive manuscript illumination and stained-glass windows, had, by the time the tapestries reached their apogee, been modified by a fast-wakening naturalism. But the underlying idea of the silhouette and of the poised body was not yet lost, and so it was natural for tapestry designers to meet these requirements. The naturalism, on the other hand, was just becoming strong enough to make the lines more gracefully flowing and the details more varied and more delicate and exact in drawing, so that the very transitional form of the art of the time made it especially well adapted to a woven rendition.

In the third place, the cartoons, even if they were not quite right in feeling when they came from the painter's hand, would be modified in the translation into the weave by the workmen themselves; for the weavers at that time were respected craftsmen with sufficient command of design to

make their own patterns for the less important orders, and were therefore perfectly able to modify and enrich the details of the cartoon of even a great painter. And no designer in the one medium of paint can ever fit his theme to the other medium of wool quite as aptly as the man who is doing the weaving himself.

Thus because the Gothic period happened to be a time when it was natural for the artists to make vivacious and decorative illustrations in clear, flat silhouettes with rich details, most of the Gothic tapestries have some measure of artistic greatness, sufficient to put them above all but the very greatest pieces of later times. Even when we discount the additions that time and our changed attitude make, the beauty of softened and blended colors, the charm of the unaccustomed and the quaint, the interest of the unfamiliar costumes, the literary flavor of old romantic times—even discounting these, they are still inherently superior. To be sure, they are rarely pretty and are sometimes frankly ugly, but with a tonic ugliness which possesses the deepest of all æsthetic merits, stimulating vitality. They have verve, energy, a pungent vividness that sharply reminds the beholder that he is alive. Their angular emphatic silhouettes and pure, highly saturated, abruptly contrasted colors catch and hold the attention and quicken all the vital responses that are essential to clear perception and full appreciation. They are a standing refutation of the many mistaken theories that would make the essence of beauty consist merely in the balanced form and symmetry, or smooth perfection of rendition, or photographic accuracy of representation. They are a forceful and convincing demonstration that in the last analysis beauty is the quality that arouses the fullest realization of life.

Within the common Gothic character there are clearly recorded local differences: the division between the French and the Flemish, not marked until the middle of the XVth century, because up to that time the Franco-Flemish school was really one and continuous. It amalgamated influences from both regions and absorbed a rather strong contribution from Italy. The center of activity was at first Paris and then at the courts of the Burgundian dukes. But after the middle of the century the divergence is rapid and clear. The French is characterized by greater simplicity, clarity, elegance, and delicacy. Even the strong uprush of realism was held in check in France by decorative sensitiveness. The most characteristic designs of the time are the

millefleurs, the finer being made in Touraine (cf. No. 8), the coarser in La Marche. The Flemish decoration, on the other hand, is sumptuous, overflowing, sometimes confused, always energetic, and strongly varied in detail. Nothing checks the relentless realism that sometimes runs even to caricature and often is fantastic (cf. the punishment scenes in No. 4). Typical of Flemish abundance are the cartoons with multiple religious scenes, heavy with rich draperies and gorgeous with infinite detail, yet not subordinating to theme the human interest of many well-delineated types of character (cf. No. 18). Brussels was the great center for the production of work of this kind, but beautiful pieces were being produced in almost every city of the Lowlands—Bruges, Tournai, Arras, and many more.

The German Gothic tapestry is quite different from both of these. It was developed almost entirely independently, under quite other conditions. While the French and Flemish shops grew up under the patronage of the great and wealthy nobles, and worked primarily for these lavish art-patrons, in Germany the nobles were impoverished and almost outcast; there was scarcely a real court, and all the wealth lay in the hand of the burghers, solid, practical folk who did not see much sense in art. So while in France and in the Lowlands the workshops were highly organized under great *entrepreneurs*, and the profits were liberal, in Germany the workshops were very small, and many of the pieces were not made professionally at all, but were the work of nuns in the convents or of ladies in their many idle hours. Thus the industry that in France and Flanders was definitely centered in the great cities such as Paris and Brussels, in Germany was scattered through many towns, primarily, however, those of south Germany and Switzerland. And, too, while the designs for the French and Flemish pieces were specially made by manuscript illuminators, painters, or professional cartoon designers, some of whom, like Maître Philippe (cf. Nos. 17-19), conducted great studios, for the German pieces the weavers themselves adapted the figures from one of the woodcuts that were the popular art of the German people or from some book illustration. So while the French and Flemish tapestries reached great heights of skill and luxury, and really were a great art, the German tapestry remained naïve and simple and most of its artistic value is the product of that very naïveté.

Toward the close of the XVth century a change begins to appear in the character of tapestry design. More and more often paintings are exactly

reproduced down to the last detail. At first sporadic products, the reproductions of the work of such masters as Roger Van der Weyden and Bernard Van Orley become more and more frequent until by the end of the first quarter of the XVIth century they are a commonplace. Yet even though tapestry is no longer entirely true to itself, these tapestry paintings are nevertheless beautiful and fit. A woven painting has not yet become an anomaly because painting in Northern Europe is still narrative and decorative. There are still poise and restraint and clear flat silhouette and rich detail.

It was not until tapestry plunged full into the tide of the Italian Renaissance that it entirely lost its Gothic merits. But when, beginning in 1515 with the arrival of Raphael's cartoons for the Pope's *Apostle* series, the weavers of the North began to depend more and more for their designs on the painters of the South and on painters trained in the South, the character of tapestry completely changed. True, tapestry in the old style was still made for two decades, but in diminishing numbers. The Renaissance had the field. In place of endlessly varied detail, the designers sought for instantly impressive effects, and these are of necessity obvious. Every-thing grew larger, coarser, more insistent on attention. Figures were monumental, floreation bold and strong, architecture massive. Even the verdures developed a new manner; great scrolling acanthus-leaves and exotic birds (cf. No. 33) took the place of the delicate field flowers and pigeons and songsters. Drama took the place of narrative. On many pieces metal thread was lavished in abundance. The whole flagrant richness of the newly modern world was called into play.

For the first time also with Renaissance tapestry, it becomes relevant to ask, Do they look like the scenes they depict?—for realism was in the full tide of its power. A hundred and fifty years before the Renaissance realism had begun to develop, inspired by the naturalism of Aristotle, whose influence had gradually filtered down from the schools to the people, and throughout the XIVth and early XVth century it had been slowly growing. The hunting tapestries of the first part of the XVth century are early examples of it. But the Gothic realism was an attempt to convey the impression of the familiar incidents of life, to get expressive gestures, to record characteristic bits of portraiture, whether of people or things or episodes, so that a Gothic tapestry can be adjudged naturalistically successful if it carries strongly the

spirit and effect of a situation regardless of whether the drawing is quite true or not (cf. No. 2). Renaissance realism, on the other hand, is not satisfied with the impression, but strives for the fact. It wishes to depict not only the world as one sees it, but as one knows it to be—knows it, moreover, after long and careful study. So in all Renaissance graphic art correct anatomy becomes of importance, solid modeling is essential, and all details must be specific.

Yet, though tapestry in the Renaissance was no longer illustrative in the old sense, it still was decoratively fine; for the painting of Italy was founded on a mural art, and the decorative traditions still held true. Outlines are still clear and expressive. There was respect for architectural structure, and details, if less complex and sensitive, are still rich and full. Color, too, is still strong and pure, though the key is heightened somewhat and the number of tones increased. Moreover, the Renaissance introduced two important new resources, the wide border and the grotesque. Hitherto the border had been a narrow floral garland, a minor adjunct easily omitted. Now it became of major importance, always essential to the beauty of the piece, often the most beautiful part of it, designed with great resource and frequently interwoven with gold and silver. The grotesque, from being originally a border decoration, soon spread itself over the whole field (cf. No. 36), mingling with amusing incongruity but with decorative consistency goats and fair ladies, trellis, flowers, and heraldic devices. What the Renaissance lacked in subtlety it made up in abundance.

During the Renaissance the tapestry industry was dominated by the Flemish cities, with Brussels at the head. She had the greatest looms, great both for the exceeding skill of the workers and for the enormous quantity of the production. Some workshops, of which the most famous was that of the Pannemaker family, specialized in exquisitely fine work rendered in the richest materials. Of this class, the most typical examples are the miniature religious tapestries in silk and metal thread, in which all the perfection of a painting was united with the sumptuousness of a most extravagant textile (cf. No. 35). But sometimes full-sized wall-hangings too were done with the same perfection and elaboration (cf. Nos. 23-25). Other shops sacrificed the perfection of workmanship to a large output, but even in the most commercially organized houses the weavers of Flanders in the XVIth century were able and conscientious craftsmen.

These same Flemish workmen were called to different countries in Europe to establish local looms. So Italy had several small temporary ateliers at this period, as did England also (cf. No. 32). But though these shops were in Italy and England, they were still predominantly Flemish. The character of local decoration and local demand influenced the design somewhat, but fundamentally the products both in cartoon and in weave were still those of the mother country. In France, however, the Flemish workmen were made the tools of the beginning of a new national revival of the art. A group of weavers was called to Fontainebleau, where, under the extravagant patronage of Francis I, the French Renaissance was taking form. These Flemings, weaving designs made by Italians, nevertheless created decorative textiles that are typically French in spirit (cf. No. 37). France alone had a strong enough artistic character to refashion the conventions of Italy and the technique of Flanders to a national idiom.

In the next century this revival of the art which survived at Fontainebleau barely fifty years was carried on in several ateliers at Paris. The workmen were still predominantly Flemish, but again their work was unmistakably French (cf. No. 38). In Trinity Hospital looms had been maintained since the middle of the XVIth century. In the gallery of the Louvre looms were set up about 1607. And the third and most important shop was established by Marc de Comans and François de la Planche at the invitation of the king. This was most important, because it later was moved to the Bièvre River, where the Gobelins family had its old dye-works, and it eventually became the great state manufactory.

Thereafter for the next two centuries the looms of Flanders and France worked in competition. Now one, now the other took precedence, but France had a slowly increasing superiority that by the middle of the XVIIIth century put her two royal looms, the Gobelin and Beauvais, definitely in the forefront of the industry.

For cartoons the looms of the two countries called on the great painters of the time, often requisitioning the work of the same painters, and sometimes even using the very same designs. Thus Van der Meulen worked both for Brussels manufacturers (cf. Nos. 53-56) and for the French state looms (cf. No. 52), and the Gobelin adapted to its uses the old Lucas *Months* that had originated in Flanders (cf. Nos. 57, 58.)

But though they did thus parallel each other in cartoons, the finished tapestries nevertheless retained their national differences. As in the Gothic period, the Flemish tapestries in all respects showed a tendency to somewhat overdo. Their figures were larger, their borders crushed fuller of flowers and fruit, their verdure heavier, their grotesques more heterogeneous, their metal threads solidier. Their abundance was rich and decorative, but lacking in refinement and grace. The French, on the other hand, kept always a certain detachment and restraint that made for clarity and often delicacy. When the Baroque taste demanded huge active figures, the French still kept theirs well within the frame. Their borders were always spaced and usually more abstract. The verdure of Aubusson can be distinguished from those of Audenarde by the fewer leaves, the lighter massing, the more dispersed lights and shades. The grotesques of France, especially in the XVIIIth century, often controlled the random fancy popularized among the Flemish weavers by introducing a central idea, a goddess above whom they could group the proper attributes (cf. No. 36), or a court fête (cf. No. 59). And when the French used metal thread it was to enrich a limited space rather than to weight a whole tapestry. In a way the opulence of the Flemish was better adapted to the medium. Certainly it produced some very beautiful tapestries. But the refinement of the French is a little more sympathetic to an overcivilized age.

With the accession of Louis XV, tapestry joined the other textile arts and painting in following furniture styles. Thereafter, until the advent of machinery put an end to tapestry as a significant art, the cabinetmaker led all the other decorators. Small pieces with small designs, light colors, delicate floral ornaments, and the reigning temporary fad—now the Chinese taste (cf. No. 71), now the pastoral (cf. No. 68)—occupied the attention of the cartoonmakers, so that the chief occupations of the court beauties of each successive decade can be read in the tapestries.

During this time France was dictating the fashions of all the Western World, so other countries were eager not only to have her tapestries, but to have her workmen weave for them in their own capitals. Accordingly, the royal family of Russia, always foreign in its tastes, sent for a group of weavers to set up a royal Russian tapestry works. Similarly, Spain sent for a Frenchman to direct her principal looms, those at Santa Barbara and Madrid, which for a decade or so had been running under a Fleming.

And meanwhile tapestry was steadily becoming more and more another form of painting. Until the middle of the XVIIIth century it remains primarily illustrative. The Renaissance designers continued to tell historical and biblical stories and to fashion the designs in the service of the tale they had to tell. With the influence of Rubens and his school (cf. No. 44), the story becomes chiefly the excuse for the composition; but the story is nevertheless still there and adequately presented. The artists of Louis XIV, when called upon to celebrate their king in tapestry, respected this quality of the art by depicting his history and his military exploits (cf. No. 52). But illustration already begins to run thin in the series of the royal residences done by the Gobelins during his reign, and with the style of his successor it runs out almost altogether. If Boucher paints the series of the *Loves of the Gods* it is not for the sake of the mythology, but for the rosy flesh and floating drapes, and Fragonard does not even bother to think of an excuse, but makes his languid nudes simply bathers (cf. No. 69). So when Louis XV is to be celebrated by his weavers the designers make one effort to invent a story by depicting his hunts, and then abandon episode and substitute portraiture (cf. No. 64).

Throughout most of the Renaissance, tapestry remained decorative as a mural painting is decorative, but in the XVIIth century, with the degeneration of all architectual feeling, tapestry lost entirely its architectual character. It was still decorative—it was decorative as the painting of the time was. The tapestries of the XVIIth century are giant easel paintings, and of the XVIIIth century woven panel paintings.

As to the textile quality, during the XVIIth century the very scale of the pieces kept them somewhat true to it. The large figures, heavy foliage, and big floral ornaments can fall successfully into wide, soft folds. But most of the tapestry of the XVIIIth century must be stretched and set in panels or frames. That they are woven is incidental, a fact to call forth wonder for the skill of the workmen, both of the dyers who perfected the numberless slight gradations of delicate tones and kept them constant, and of the almost unbelievably deft weavers who could ply the shuttle so finely and exactly and grade these delicate tones to reproduce soft modeled flesh, fluttering draperies, billowing clouds, spraying fountains, and the sheen and folds of different materials. But that they are woven is scarcely a fact to be considered in the artistic estimate. The only advantage of the woven

decorations over the painted panel is that they present a softer surface to relieve the cold glitter of rooms. Otherwise as paintings they stand or fall. Even the border has usually been reduced to a simulated wood or stucco frame.

During this gradual change through five hundred years in the artistic qualities of tapestry the technical tricks of the weavers underwent corresponding modification. In the Gothic period the drawing depended primarily upon a strong dark outline, black or brown, that was unbroken, and that was especially important whether the design was affiliated rather with panel painting (cf. No. 1) or with the more graphic miniature illustration (cf. No. 5). Even the lesser accessories were all drawn in clear outline. Within a given color area, transitions from tone to tone were made by hatchings, little bars of irregular length of one of the shades that fitted into alternate bars of the other shade, like the teeth of two combs interlocked. And for shadows and emphasis of certain outlines, some of the Gothic weavers had a very clever trick of dropping stitches (cf. No. 1), so that a series of small holes in the fabric takes the place of a dark line. During the Renaissance the outline becomes much narrower, and is used only for the major figures, a device that sometimes makes the figures look as if they had been cut out and applied to the design. Hatching, if used at all, is much finer than in the earlier usage, consisting now of only single lines of one color shading into the next. In the work of Fontainebleau (cf. Nos. 36, 37), the dotted series of holes between colors is still used to give a subordinate outline. During the XVIIth century hatching is scarcely used at all, and the outline has practically disappeared. During the XVIIIth century the French weavers perfected a trick which obviated any break in the weave where the color changes, thus enabling tapestry to approximate even closer to painting effects.

To the weavers who adjusted these tricks to the varying demands of the cartoons, and so translated painted patterns in a woven fabric, is due quite as much credit for the finished work of art as to the painters who first made the design. Famous painters did prepare tapestry designs. Aside from the masters of the Middle Ages to whom tapestries are attributed, we have positive evidence that, among others, Jacques Daret, Roger Van der Weyden, Raphael, Giulio Romano (cf. Nos. 23-25), Le Brun, Rubens, Coypel (cf. Nos. 62, 63), Boucher (cf. Nos. 67, 68), Watteau, Fragonard (cf.

No. 69), and Vernet (cf. No. 70), all worked on tapestry designs. The master weavers who could transpose their designs deserve to rank with them in honor.

Yet we know relatively little of these master weavers. Many names of tapicers appear in tax-lists and other documents, but not until the XVIIIth century do the names often represent to us definite personalities, and until then we can only occasionally credit a man with his surviving work. From the long lists of names and the great numbers of remaining tapestries a few only can be connected. Among the greatest of these is Nicolas Bataille, of Paris, who wove the famous set of the *Apocalypse* now in the Cathedral of Angers; Pasquier Grenier, of Tournai, to whom the *Wars of Troy* and related sets can be accredited (cf. No. 7), but who apparently was an *entrepreneur* rather than a weaver; Pieter Van Aelst, who was so renowned that the cartoons of Raphael were first entrusted to him; William Pannemaker, another Brussels man, who had supreme taste and skill, and his relative Pierre, almost as skilful; Marc Comans and François de la Planche, the Flemings who set up the looms in Paris that developed into the Gobelins (cf. No. 38); Jean Lefévre, who worked first in the gallery of the Louvre and then had his studio in the Gobelins (cf. Nos. 39, 40); the Van der Beurchts, of Brussels (cf. Nos. 42, 56), and Leyniers (cf. Nos. 26, 27), and Cozette, most famous weaver of the Gobelins. Such men as these, and many more whose names are lost or are neglected because we do not know their work, were in their medium as important artists as the painters whose designs they followed.

With the passing of such master craftsmen the art of tapestry died. When men must compete with machines their work is no more respected, and so tapestry is no longer the natural medium of expression for the culture of the times. Tapestries are still being made, but there is no genuine vitality in the art and little merit in its product. It exists today only as an exhausted and irrelevant persistence from the past, and, as a fine art, doomed to failure and ultimate extinction.

P.A.



The Annunciation

No. 1



The Chase

No. 2

CATALOGUE

Abbreviations: H. (Height); W. (Width); ft. (Feet); in. (Inches). "Right" & "Left," refer to right & left of the spectator



1 FRANCO-FLEMISH, POSSIBLY ARRAS, BEGINNING OF XV OR END OF XIV CENTURY

THE ANNUNCIATION: *The Virgin, in a blue robe lined with red, is seated before a reading-desk in a white marble portico with a tile floor. Behind her is a red and metal gold brocade. The lily is in a majolica jar. The angel, in a green robe with yellow high lights lined with red, has alighted in a garden without. In the sky, God the Father holding the globe and two angels bearing a shield.*

Wool, Silk, Gold.
H. 11 ft. 4 in.
W. 9 ft. 6 in.

The treatment of the sky in two-toned blue and white striations, as well as the conventional landscape without perspective, with small oak and laurel trees, is characteristic of a number of tapestries of the opening years of the XVth century. Most of them depicted hunting scenes. But there was one famous religious piece, the *Passion* of the Cathedral of Saragossa. In the drawing of the figures and some of the details the piece is closely related to the paintings of that Paris school of which Jean Malouel is the most famous member. The work is by no means by Malouel, but it is similar to that of one of his lesser contemporaries, whose only known surviving work is a set of six panels painted on both sides, two of which are in the Cuvellier Collection at Niort and the others in the Mayer Van der Bergh Collection at Antwerp. The very primitively rendered Eternal Father is almost identical

with the one that appears in several of the panels; the roughly indicated shaggy grass is the same, the rather unusual angle of the angel's wings recurs in the Cuvellier *Annunciation*, as does the suspended poise of the Virgin's attitude. The Virgin's reading-desk, too, is almost identical, though shown in the panel at the other side of the scene. The long, slim-fingered hands and the pointed nose and chin of the Virgin are characteristic of the school.

The tiles in the portico, so carefully rendered, are of interest because they are very similar to the earliest-known tile floor still in position—that of the Caracciolo Chapel in Naples. Some of the same patterns are repeated, notably that of the Virgin's initial and the star, which is more crudely rendered. The colors, too, are approximately the same, the brown being a fair rendering of the manganese purple of the chapel tiles. The majolica vase is also interesting as illustrating a type of which few intact examples are left.

The piece maintains a high level of æsthetic expression. The religious emotion is intensely felt and is adequately conveyed in the wistful sadness of the Virgin's face and the expectant suspense of her poised body. The portico seems removed from reality and flooded by a direct heavenly light, in its shining whiteness contrasting with the deep blue-green background. This tapestry by virtue of its intense and elevated feeling, purified by æsthetic calm and by its exceptional decorative vividness, ranks with the very great masterpieces of the graphic arts.

Exhibited:
*Chicago Art
Institute, Gothic
Exhibition, 1921.*

Lent by *P. W.
French &
Company.*

2 FRANCO-FLEMISH, EARLY XV CENTURY

THE CHASE: A man in a long dark-blue coat and high red hat and a lady in a brown brocade dress and ermine turban watch a dog in leather armor attack a bear. A landscape with trees and flowers is indicated without perspective and a castle in simple outline is projected against a blue and white striated sky.

*Wool and Gold.
H. 5 ft. 5 in.
W. 5 ft. 11 in.*

This tapestry is an important example of a small group of hunting scenes of the early XVth century. It is closely related in style to the famous pair of large hunting tapestries in the collection of the Duke of Devonshire. It is not definitely known where any of these pieces were woven, but Arras is taken as a safe assumption, as that was the center of weaving at the time, and these tapestries are the finest production known of the period.

Exhibited:
*South Kensington
Museum, French-
English
Retrospective
Exhibition of
Textiles, 1921.*

The very simple figures sharply silhouetted against the contrasting ground have a decidedly architectural quality, perfectly adapted to mural decoration. Yet the scene seems very natural and the persons have marked and attractive personalities.

These exceedingly rare pieces mark the great wave of naturalism that began sweeping over Europe about 1350 and they exemplify strikingly one of the finest qualities of the primitive—the impressive universality and objectivity that come from the freshness of the artist's vision. Looking straight at the thing itself, free from all the presuppositions that come from an inherited convention, the draftsman saw the essentials and recorded them directly without any confusing elaboration of technique. He was completely absorbed by the unsolved problems of the task, too occupied with the difficulty of rendering the central outstanding features of the scene to be diverted by personal affectations. His realization thus became vivid and intimate, his rendition achieved a singularity and epic force never again to be found in tapestry.

Illustrated:
*La Renaissance de
l'Art français, 1921,*
p. 104; *Burlington,*
vol. 38, opp. p. 171.
*DeMotte, Les
Tapisseries
gothiques,*
Deuxième Série.

Lent by *Demotte.*

This is one of the few tapestries that have been improved by age. Time has spread over it a slight gray bloom that seems to remove it from the actual world, giving it the isolation that is so important a factor in æsthetic effect; yet the depth and strength of the colors have not been weakened, for we interpret the grayness as a fine veil through which the colors shine with their original purity.

3 FLANDERS, MIDDLE XV CENTURY

THE ANNUNCIATION, THE NATIVITY, AND THE ANNOUNCEMENT TO THE SHEPHERDS: *At the left in a Gothic chapel the Annunciation. The Virgin, in a richly jeweled and brocaded robe, reads the Holy Book.*

Wool.

H. 15 ft. 7 in.

W. 14 ft. 7 in.

The angel in rich robes kneels before her. The lilies are in a dinanderie vase. Through the open door a bit of landscape is seen, and in a room beyond the chapel two women sit reading. The Nativity, at the right, is under a pent roof. The Virgin, Joseph, and Saint Elizabeth kneel in adoration about the Holy Babe, who lies on the flower-strewn grass. John kneels in front of his mother, and in the foreground an angel also worships. Above and beyond the stable the three shepherds sit tending their flocks, and an angel bearing the announcement inscribed on a scroll flutters down to them from Heaven. Oak-trees, rose-vines, and blossoming orange-trees in the grass.



*The Annunciation, The Nativity, and The Announcement to the
Shepherds* No. 3



Scenes from the Roman de la Rose

No. 4

This tapestry belongs to a small and very interesting group, all evidently the work of one designer. The three famous *Conversations Galantes* (long erroneously called the *Baillée des Roses*) in the Metropolitan Museum are by the same man, as are the four panels of the *History of Lohengrin* in Saint Catherine's Church, Cracow, the fifth fragmentary panel of the series being in the Musée Industrielle, Cracow. A fragment from the same designer showing a party of hunters is in the Church of Notre Dame de Saumur de Nantilly, and another fragment depicting a combat is in the Musée des Arts Decoratifs. Three small fragments—one with a single figure of a young man with a swan, like the Metropolitan pieces, on a striped ground, another showing a king reading in a portico very similar to the portico of the *Annunciation*, and the third showing a group of people centered about a king—were in the Heilbronner Collection.

Schmitz points out^[1] a connection between the three Metropolitan pieces and the series of seven pieces depicting the life of Saint Peter in the Beauvais Cathedral, with an eighth piece in the Cluny Musée, and it is quite evident that the cartoons are the work of the same man. But whereas the other pieces all have the same characteristics in the weaving, this series shows a somewhat different technique in such details as the outline and the hatchings, so that one must assume they were woven on another loom.

Fortunately, there is documentary information on one set of the type that enables us to say definitely where and when the whole group was made. The *Lohengrin* set was ordered by Philip the Good from the first Grenier of Tournai in 1462. There can be no reasonable doubt that the set in Saint Catherine's Church is the same, for in this set the knight is quite apparently modeled after Duke Philip himself, judging from the portraits of him in both the *Romance of Gerard de Rousillon* (Vienna Hof-bibliothèque) and in the *History of Haynaut* (Bibliothèque Royale, Brussels).

Schmitz asserts that it is almost certainly useless to seek the author of these cartoons among contemporary painters, as they are probably the work of a professional cartoon painter, of which the Dukes of Burgundy kept several in their service—and this is probably true. But artists were not as specialized then as they are now, and even a professional tapestry designer might very well on occasion turn his hand to illustrating a manuscript or making a sketch for an enamel, so that it is not impossible that further research in the other contemporary arts may bring to light more information about this marked personality who created so individual a style.

This tapestry is exceedingly interesting, not only for its marked style of drawing and its quaint charm, but for the direct sincerity of the presentation and the brilliant and rather unaccustomed range of colors.

Lent by Duveen
Brothers.

4 FLANDERS, MIDDLE XV CENTURY

SCENES FROM THE ROMAN DE LA ROSE: *This piece illustrates one of the most popular romances of the Middle Ages, the Romance of the Rose, the first part of which was written in 1337 by Guillaume de Lorris, the second part in 1378 by Jean de Meung, and translated into English by Chaucer. The culminating scenes are represented. Jealousy has imprisoned Bel Accueil in a tower because he helped the Lover see the Rose after Jealousy had forbidden it. The Lover calls all his followers, Frankness, Honor, Riches, Nobility of Heart, Leisure, Beauty, Courage, Kindness, Pity, and a host of others, to aid him in rescuing the prisoner. In the course of the struggle Scandal, one of Jealousy's henchmen, is trapped by two of the Lover's followers posing as*

Wool and Silk.
H. 8 ft. 4 in.
W. 20 ft. 4 in.

Formerly in Skipton
Castle, Ireland.

Pilgrims, who cut his throat and cut out his tongue. With the aid of Venus, the Lover finally wins.

The piece is very close in drawing to the illustrations of the Master of the Golden Fleece,^[2] whom Lindner has identified as Philip de Mazarolles. The long bony, egg-shaped heads that look as if the necks were attached as an afterthought, the shoe-button eyes, flat mouths, and peaked noses all occur in his many illustrations. Characteristic of him, too, are the crowded grouping of the scene and the great care in presenting the accessories, every gown being an individual design, whereas many of his contemporary illustrators contented themselves with rendering the general style without variations. The conventional trees are probably the weaver's interpolations. The top of the tapestry being gone, there is no possibility of knowing whether his customary architectural background was included or not.

Exhibited:
*Chicago Art
Institute, Gothic
Exhibition, 1921.*

Lent by P. W.
*French &
Company.*

The tapestry is interesting, not only because it is quaint, but because it is a vivid illustration of the spirit of the time—virile, cruel, yet self-consciously moralistic.

5 FLANDERS, MIDDLE XV CENTURY

THE VINTAGE: *This piece was probably originally one of a series of the Months, representing September. Groups of lords and ladies have strolled down from the castle in the background to watch the peasants gathering and pressing the grapes.*

Wool.
H. 10 ft. 9 in.
W. 17 ft. 5½ in.

The costumes and the drawing indicate that the piece was made in Burgundy at the time of Philip the Good. In fact, it is so close to the work of one of the most prolific of the illustrators who worked for Philip the Good that it is safe to assume that the original drawing for the cartoons was his work. In the pungency of the illustration and the vivacity of the episodes as well as in numerous details it follows closely the characteristics of

Formerly in the
Collection of
Edouard Aynard,
Paris.

Exhibited:
*Exhibition of the
Middle Ages and
the Renaissance,*

Loysot Lyedet. Here are the same strong-featured faces with large prominent square mouths, the same exaggeratedly long and thin legs with suddenly bulging calves on the men, the same rapidly sketched flat hands, and the same attitudes. The very exact drawing of the bunches of grapes parallels the exactness with which he renders the household utensils in his indoor scenes, and the dogs, while they are of types familiar in all the illustrations of the time, have the decided personalities and alert manner that he seemed to take particular pleasure in giving them.

Old Palace of Sagan, Paris, 1913.

Another tapestry that seems to be from the same hand is *Le Bal de Sauvages* in l'Eglise de Nantilly de Saumur.

The piece is one of the most vivid and convincing illustrations of the life of the time that has come down to us in tapestry form. The silhouetting of the figures against contrasting colors and the structural emphasis of the vertical lines give the design great clarity and strength.

Reproduced:
Les Arts, Sept.,
1913; *Gazette des
Beaux Arts*, 1913.

Lent by *Jacques
Seligmann &
Company.*

Loysot Lyedet was working for the Dukes of Burgundy in 1461. He died about 1468. Among the most famous of his illustrations are those of the *History of Charles Martel* (Bibliothèque Royale, Brussels) *History of Alexander* (Bibliothèque Nationale, Paris) and the *Roman History* (Bibliothèque de l'Arsenal, Paris.)

6 GERMANY, PROBABLY NUREMBERG, MIDDLE XV CENTURY

SCENES FROM THE LIFE OF CHRIST: *The Life of Christ is shown in eight small scenes, beginning with the Entrance into Jerusalem, the Farewell to his Mother, the Last Supper, the Agony in the Garden, the Carrying of the Cross, the Crucifixion, the Pieta, and the Entombment.*

Wool and Gold.
H. 3 ft. 6 in.
W. 7 ft. 6 in.

The scenes in this tapestry were apparently adapted from the illustrations from a Nuremberg manuscript of the middle of the XVth century. Of course, the weaving may have been done later. The simplified arrangement

of the scenes with a reduction to a minimum of the number of actors, the relative size of the figures to the small squares of the compositions, the marked indebtedness in the use of line and light and shade to woodcuts, and the courageous but not altogether easy use of the direct profile, all bring the pieces into close relationship with such book illustrations as those of George Pfinzing's book of travels (*The Pilgrimage to Jerusalem*), now in the City Library of Nuremberg.^[3] In fact, the parallelism is so very close, the tapestry may well have been adapted from illustrations by the same man, the curiously conventionalized line-and-dot eyes being very characteristic of the Pfinzing illustrations and not common to all the school.

In weaving many of the figures the warp is curved to follow the contours.

The naïve directness and unassuming sincerity of the piece give it great interest.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

7 TOURNAI, THIRD QUARTER XV CENTURY

THE HISTORY OF HERCULES: *Hercules, clad in a magnificent suit of shining black armor, rides into the thickest tumult of a furious battle; with sword in his right hand, he skillfully parries the thrust of a huge lance, while with the other hand he deals a swinging backhand blow that smites an enemy footman into insensibility. His next opponent, obviously bewildered and frightened, has half-turned to flee. The whole apparatus of mediæval combat is shown in intense and crowded action. The piece is incomplete.*

Wool.
H. 10 ft. 6 in.
W. 8 ft. 9 in.

This tapestry illustrates one of the favorite stories of the Middle Ages, and was undoubtedly originally one of a set. In design it is closely related to the famous *Wars of Troy* series, many examples of which are known and some of the first sketches for which are in the Louvre. It is also closely related to the *History of Titus* set in the Cathedrale de Notre Dame de Nantilly de Saumur.^[4] Both of these sets are signed by Jean Van Room, and this piece also is undoubtedly from his cartoon. All of these pieces were probably woven between 1460 and 1470.

Jean Van Room (sometimes called de Bruxelles) is one of the most interesting personalities connected with the history of Gothic tapestry. He was a cartoon painter and probably conducted a large studio, judging from the number of pieces of his which are left to us. Fortunately, he had a habit of signing his name on obscure parts of the designs, such as the borders of garments. His work extends over sixty years and changes markedly in style during that time, adapting itself to the changing taste of his clients. This piece illustrates his earliest manner. In the succeeding decades he is more and more affected by the Renaissance and the Italian influence, until his latest pieces (cf. No. 21) are quite unlike these first designs. At the close of the century he began to collaborate with Maître Philippe, evidently a younger man, who had had Italian instruction and was less restrained by early Gothic training (cf. Nos. 17-19).

Jean Van Room seems to have done designs for enamels, also, that were executed in the studio of the so-called Monvaerni. In the collection of Otto H. Kahn is a *Jesus before Pilate* very close in style to Jean Van Room's early work,^[5] on which appear the letters M E R A, which might even be a pious misspelling of Room, for similar confused signatures appear on tapestries known to be his. A triptych with *Crucifixion* in the collection of Charles P. Taft^[6] has figures very close to the *Crucifixion* tapestry in the Cathedral of Angers done by Van Room in his middle period. According to Marquet de Vasselot, this enamel bears the letters JENRAGE, but M. de Vasselot also comments on its illegibility in the present condition of the enamel. Could he have misread a letter or two? Still another triptych with *Crucifixion*, in the Hermitage,^[7] actually repeats two figures from the Angers *Crucifixion* with only very slight variations.

Jean Van Room borrowed liberally from various other artists at different stages of his career. In the *Wars of Troy*, the *History of Titus*, and this piece he seems to have relied primarily on Jean le Tavernier for his models, the affiliation being especially close in the *Wars of Troy*. Le Tavernier is known to have illustrated the *Wars of Troy*,^[8] and Jean Van Room, judging from the close stylistic relations of his Troy tapestries with le Tavernier's drawings, evidently took his hints from this lost manuscript.



The Vintage

No. 5



Entombment on Millefleurs

No. 8

This piece was probably woven under Pasquier Grenier at Tournai, as were the *Wars of Troy*, on which there are some documents.

This tapestry presents with extraordinary vividness the fury, din, excessive effort, hot excitement, and blinding confusion of crowded hand-to-hand conflicts that marked mediæval warfare. It must have been conceived

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

and rendered by an eye-witness who knew how to select and assemble the raw facts of the situation with such honesty and directness that an overwhelming impression of force and tumult is created, and it was woven for patrons, the fighting Dukes of Burgundy, by whom every gruesome incident would be observed with relish and every fine point of individual combat noted with a shrewd and appraising eye.

8 FRANCE, END XV CENTURY

ENTOMBMENT ON MILLEFLEURS: *Christ lies on the tomb which is inscribed "Humani Generis Redemptori." John in a red cloak, the Virgin in a blue cloak over a red brocaded dress, and Mary Magdalene in a red cloak over a green dress stand behind the tomb. At the head, removing the crown of thorns, stands Joseph of Arimathea and at the foot Nicodemus. Both Joseph and Nicodemus are in richly brocaded robes. Borders at the sides only of alternate blue and red squares inscribed I H S and M A surrounded by jeweled frames. Millefleurs on a blue ground. In the upper left corner the monogram I S and in the upper right W S, with a scroll under each bearing the inscription "de Mailly."*

Wool.
H. 2 ft. 10 in.
W. 7 ft. 10 in.

This tapestry is an unusually delicately and perfectly rendered example of the *millefleurs aux personnages* of France of the late Gothic period. A small piece like this was undoubtedly made for a private chapel, probably that of the de Mailly family. This quality of millefleurs was probably woven in Touraine. An altar frontal showing the Pieta which is very similar in style is in the Kunstgewerbe Museum.

The drawing has the nice exactness of a finished miniature, the workmanship the brilliance of enamel; yet both are transfigured by the vivid conception of the tragic event. Its utter pathos is expressed with moving power. We are in the presence of an unutterably solemn moment.

Lent by Demotte.

9 FRANCE, END XV CENTURY

MILLEFLEURS ARMORIAL WITH WILD MEN: *On a delicate millefleurs ground a wild man and woman hold an armorial shield*

surmounted by a winged helmet.

The wild men, probably a modified revival of the classical satyrs in modified form, were very popular in France in the XIIIth and XIVth centuries. There are tapestries extant depicting the balls where all the company came dressed in hairy tights to represent these creatures. Froissart recounts an episode of a ball at the Hotel St. Pol in Paris in 1392 when the king and five of his companions came in such costumes, all chained together, and the flax used to imitate the hair caught fire from a torch, so that in an instant all were enveloped in flames. The king was saved by the presence of mind of his cousin, who enveloped him in her skirts, and another was saved by jumping into a tub of water he had noticed earlier in the evening in an adjacent service-room. The others were burned to death.

Wool and Silk.
H. 4 ft. 6 in.
W. 3 ft.

Formerly in the C.
D. Barney
Collection.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

10 FRANCE, BEGINNING XVI CENTURY

MILLEFLEURS WITH SHEPHERDS AND THE SHIELD OF THE RIGAUT FAMILY: *Against a background of conventionalized millefleurs, shepherds and shepherdesses and their flock. In the center, two peasants holding a shield, evidently of the Rigaut family. In the corners the shield of Rigaut and of another family. The tapestry was evidently made to celebrate a marriage, the corner shields signifying the joining of the families, an oblique reference being intended in the pairing of the shepherds and shepherdesses. A scroll in the center bears the inscription "Par Ici Passe Rigaut."*

Wool.
H. 7 ft. 10 in.
W. 10 ft. 7 in.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

The naïveté both of the characterization and of the drawing that emphasizes the structural and silhouette character of the figures contributes greatly to the charm of this piece. The clean, sharp rendering of the millefleurs enhances the decorative effect. The piece is probably the work of a small provincial loom.

11 FRANCE, PROBABLY LA MARCHE, BEGINNING XVI CENTURY

MILLEFLEURS WITH ANIMALS: *Against a large-scale millefleurs ground on blue, deer are playing about a fountain within a paddock. On a fence-post perches a peacock. Outside the fence a fox waits, watching slyly. In the background conventional castles.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 5 ft. 7 in.
W. 9 ft. 4 in.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

The floreation is rather unusual, as it shows the transition from the Gothic millefleurs to the Renaissance verdure. The enlarged scale of the flowers and the use of the iris and the scrolled thistle-leaves in the foreground show the influence of the Renaissance, but the daisies and wild roses are still Gothic in feeling, as are the unusually charming and vivacious deer. The conventional rendering of the water is skillfully managed. The sly fox is especially well characterized.



Millefleurs with Shepherds and the Shield of the Rigaut Family
No. 10



Pastoral Scene

No. 13

12 FRANCE, PROBABLY LA MARCHE, EARLY XVI CENTURY

MILLEFLEURS WITH ANIMALS: *Millefleurs with animals on a blue ground. At the top a narrow strip of conventionalized hilly landscape.*

Many tapestries of this type were woven in France at the end of the XVth and beginning of the XVIth century. They are one of the most successful types of tapestry decoration, the quaint animals in this piece being especially charming, and one of the most generally useful kinds of wall decoration, so that the

Wool.
H. 4 ft. 5 in.
W. 9 ft. 5 in.

Lent by Dikran K.
Kelekian.

demand for them was large and continuous. As a result, the style was produced almost without modification for over a hundred years. Only the bit of landscape at the top indicates that this was woven in the beginning of the XVIth century and not in the middle of the XVth.

13 FRANCE, LATE XV CENTURY

PASTORAL SCENE: *Two ladies have strolled into the country with their lords, who are on the way to the hunt, one with a falcon and the other with a spear and dog. On the way they have stopped to talk to a group of peasants who are tending their flocks and to play with their children. One young peasant girl is gathering a basket of grapes.*

Wool.
H. 9 ft. 6 in.
W. 9 ft.

Such peasant scenes as this were much in demand during the XVth century. A piece very similar both in general spirit and in detailed drawing and facial types is in the Musée des Arts Decoratifs. In this two lords are watching a large group of woodcutters.

The piece is an excellent illustration of the clarity of French design. Each figure stands out almost entirely detached against the background. Yet, nevertheless, the naturalness of the grouping is not sacrificed. The piece conveys extraordinarily the impression of a real scene, a common daily occurrence among people that we might reasonably expect to know, at which we are allowed to be present in spite of the intervening four hundred years.

Formerly in the De
Zolte Collection.

Lent by *Duveen
Brothers.*

Some of the tricks of drawing and the types portrayed are so very similar to those in some of the stained-glass windows of St. Etienne du Mont and of St. Germain-l'Auxerrois the cartoons must be by members of the same school, one of the groups of l'Ile de France, and may quite possibly be by the same man.

14-16 FLANDERS, FIRST QUARTER XVI CENTURY

THREE PIECES FROM A SERIES ILLUSTRATING THE CREED: *This series of scenes illustrating the Creed begins (No. 14) with the Creation of the World. The designer, evidently with some allegorical poem in mind, includes in the scene Sapientia, Potencia, and Benignitas, depicted, in characteristic medieval form, as three richly dressed women. In the center scene these three offer the world to God. On the right, Gubernacio, Redempcio, and Caritas stand under the throne of the Trinity.*

Wool and Silk.

No. 14:

H. 11 ft. 6 in.

w. 14 ft. 2 in.

No. 15:

H. 10 ft. 9 in.

w. 7 ft. 3½ in.

No. 16:

H. 11 ft.

w. 10 ft. 5 in.

In the second piece (No. 15) the series continues with the Life of Christ, beginning with the Annunciation, the Nativity, and the Adoration of the Kings.

Reverting to the older tradition of the XIVth century that had been almost displaced during the XVth century, all the events of Christ's public life are omitted, and the third piece (No. 16) depicts the scenes of the Passion, including the popular interpolation of Christ's farewell to his Mother, with the Apostles in the background, the Resurrection, and finally Christ taking his place at the right hand of God while the angels sing hosannas.

Below, throughout the series, is the set of the Apostles facing Prophets, symbolic of the parallelism of the Old and New Testaments, each with a scroll bearing his speech in the conventional responses depicted in so many works of art of the period. So Peter (No. 14), says, "I believe in God the Father Omnipotent," and Jeremiah, who faces him, replies, "You invoke the Father who made the earth and builded the heavens." Next (No. 15) comes Andrew, who originally faced David, a figure now missing. The next pair, John and Daniel, is also missing. There follow (No. 16) Thomas, who originally faced Hosea, and John the Lesser, who is opposite Amos. Above, on either side of the Nativity (No. 15), is introduced another pair, John the Greater and Isaiah.

The complete piece, of which number 16 is the right-hand end, was formerly in the Toledo Cathedral, then in the collection of Asher Wertheimer, of London. The present owner is unknown.^[9] Another rendition was in the Vatican, but disappeared in the middle of the XIXth century.^[10]

Tapestries illustrating the Creed were common throughout the Middle Ages. They appear frequently in XIVth-century inventories, and a number of examples from the XVth and early XVIth century are left to us. The Apostles and Prophets arranged in pairs are a common feature of this type of tapestry.

The cartoons are evidently the work of the painter who painted the ceiling of the Church of St. Guy at Naarden, whom Dr. Six tentatively identifies as Albert Claes.^[11]

Formerly in Evora
Palace, Portugal.

The similarity is too close to be overlooked. The Christ of the Naarden *Resurrection*^[12] and this *Resurrection* are almost identical, the face of God the Father in the *Assumption* is almost identical with that of an onlooker in the Naarden *Betrayal*,^[13] and Adam in the first piece of this series closely resembles the Christ of the Naarden *Flagellation*.^[14] But more indicative are the lesser peculiarities common to both series. There are in both the same curiously flattened and slightly distorted skulls with very large ears, the same large eyes with heavy arched lids and eyebrows close above them, oblique and not quite correctly placed in the three-quarter views, and always looking beyond their focus. The mouths, too, in some of the faces are overemphasized in the same way, and the feet have the same quaint distortion, being seen from above, as in the figure of the Prophet John (No. 15). And in very conspicuous minor agreement, the cross has a strongly indicated and rigidly conventionalized graining identical in the two renditions. The attitude of the Christ and the indication of the garment in the Toledo tapestry is very close to that in the Naarden painting.



The Creation of the World

No. 14



Four Scenes from the Life of Christ

No. 17

The floreateion was probably introduced by the weaver. The delightfully exact scene of the owl scolded by a magpie, while a pigeon sits near by and another bird flutters about (No. 14), is repeated with slight variations in a number of XVIth-century pieces.

The drawing in these tapestries is rather unusually primitive for pieces of this period, but the figures have a broad monumental character and a direct sincerity of bearing that make them very convincing.

Lent by Demotte.

17-19 FLANDERS, PROBABLY BRUSSELS, BEGINNING XVI CENTURY

THREE PIECES FROM A SERIES ILLUSTRATING THE CREED: *In the first piece (No. 17) four scenes from the Life of Christ are portrayed: the Adoration of the Kings, the Presentation at the Temple, the meeting of Christ and John, and Christ among the Doctors. In the*

Wool and Silk.
No. 17:
H. 11 ft. 10 in.
W. 17 ft. 6 in.
No. 18:
H. 11 ft. 7 in.

corner sits a prophet, probably David. The piece undoubtedly began with the Nativity, at the left, and possibly the Annunciation, with the Apostle Andrew in the other corner. This would indicate that the piece was the second in the series, the first probably having been the Creation of the Earth, with Peter and Jeremiah.

w. 7 ft. 5 in.
No. 19:
H. 12 ft.
w. 26 ft.

The second piece (No. 18) shows the Circumcision and the Assumption of the Virgin, and evidently included at least one more scene at the right.

The third piece (No. 19) shows the full scene of the Last Judgment with a personage who seems to be Philip in one corner and in the other Zephaniah. The piece is complete except, possibly, for a border. A tapestry from the same cartoon with a narrow border of flowers is in the Louvre. Christ, enthroned, is surrounded by the Virgin, Saint John, and the eleven Apostles. Angels, bearing instruments of the Passion and sounding trumpets flutter through the sky. At the right of the throne angels come bearing crowns for the elect. Below the dead are rising from the graves. Before the throne of Christ Justice bearing a sword and Pity bearing a lily come to punish the Seven Deadly Sins, Pride, Avarice, Luxury, Greed, Anger, Envy, and Laziness, an episode adopted from the Mystery Plays. On the border of the robe of the Virgin appear the letters WOL and on the border of the robe of the last Apostle at Christ's left the letters RIM DACI BAPTISTA ORADI.

The Last Judgment was formerly in the Evora Palace, Portugal, and is illustrated from the Louvre example in Migeon, *Les Arts de Tissue*, p. 220; in part, in E. Mâle, *L'Art religieux de la fin du Moyen Age en France*, p. 501; Burlington, vol. 20, p. 9; *Figaro Illustré*, 1911.

Seven other large tapestries very closely related to these are known. They represent various episodes involving Christ and numerous allegorical figures that have not been identified. Three of these are in the collection of Baron de Zuylen du Nyevelt de Haar, two in the Burgos Cathedral, and two others have passed into private collections and been lost sight of.^[15] Another smaller piece, apparently of the same series, was number X in the Morgan Collection. Three duplicates are also in Hampton Court.

The Circumcision and Assumption is illustrated in Demotte, *Les Tapisseries gothiques*, Première Série, pl. 39.

The series is closely related also to the *Life of the Virgin* set in the Royal Collection at Madrid, and also the *Presentation in the Temple* of the Martin le Roy Collection. The cartoons are clearly the work of Maître Philippe, and the weaving was evidently done in Flanders, probably in Brussels, about 1510. Marquet de Vasselot suggests that the cartoons of the Martin le Roy piece and of the Madrid series were done after a second master under the influence of Gerard David.^[16] Destrée, following Wauters, suggests Jean de Bruxelles, known author of the cartoon for the *Communion of Herkenbald*, another Maître Philippe piece, to which he sees a resemblance,^[17] and Thiéry repeats the claim, but on far-fetched evidence.^[18]

Certainly the types are very close to those of Gerard David. Some of the figures on David's *Tree of Mary* in the Lyons Museum^[19] are repeated almost exactly, and some of the female figures are very like the Saint in the *Marriage of Catherine* in the San Luca Academy at Rome.^[20] But other types, such as Zacharias in the meeting of Christ and John, are more reminiscent of Hugo Van der Goes, being, for instance, almost identical with Joseph of Arimathea in the *Descent from the Cross* in the National Museum, Naples,^[21] even to such details as the drawing and placing of the ear. The glimpses of landscapes, too, are clearly derived from Hugo in their composition and details, and even the floreations are close to those in some of Hugo's work, notably the *Original Sin* in the Imperial Gallery of Vienna,^[22] where one finds the same upspringing sheaf of iris. The work would seem to be that of a lesser eclectic, such as the author of the *Life of Mary* in the Bishops' Palace at Evora.

In all the pieces there are intense sincerity and real grandeur of design. The *Last Judgment*, in the musical swinging together of the draperies, the perfect control of the great composition, and in the fine development of the dominance of Christ without sacrifice of the minor episodes, as well as in the power of expression of the thrilling solemnity of the moment, deserves to rank with the greatest interpretations of the subject.

Lent by Demotte.

20 BRUSSELS, BEGINNING OF XVI CENTURY

SCENES FROM A ROMANCE: *A queen surrounded by her court awaits the preparation of a document. There is a general interchange of documents among the courtiers at the right. In the background, upper left, a knight indites a letter, and on the opposite side two knights wait on horseback. The scenes illustrate some contemporary romance and are closely related to the Court of Love tapestries that were so often woven at this time.*

Wool and Silk.

H. 12 ft. 3 in.

W. 13 ft. 2 in.

Formerly in the
Morgan Collection.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

The cartoon, like those of the *Court of Love* scenes, is the work of the studio of Maître Philippe. Jean Van Room probably collaborated, as his signature appears on a very similar tapestry of *David and Bathsheba* in the Royal Spanish Collection.^[23] As in that tapestry, the elegantly dressed persons are quite typical of the prosperous burghers of the time and might well be used as fashion plates. The composition is skillful in the balancing of the groups and the massing of the drapes to form a support for the dominant figure of the queen.

21 BRUSSELS, EARLY XVI CENTURY

THE TRIUMPH OF DAVID: *David carrying the head of Goliath on his sword and surrounded by musicians is followed by King Saul and Jonathan on horseback. In the background a hilly landscape with the tents of the Hebrews. A narrow floral border.*

H. 13 ft. 9 in.

W. 22 ft. 1 in.

Barberini
Collection; Ffoulke
Collection.

Illustrated: *Ffoulke
Collection*, opp. p.
43. Exhibited:

*Exposition d'Art
ancien bruxellois,
Brussels, 1905, No.
XXI. Illustrated:
Destrée, Catalogue
of same, pl. XXIV.*

The cartoon was painted by Jean Van Room, his signature appearing on another piece^[24] of the same series in the Musée du Cinquantenaire, Brussels. Maître Philippe must have collaborated with him in this work, for a strong Italian influence is evident which appears only in the Van Room tapestries that have had Philippe's assistance.

Lent by Mrs. Wm.
C. Van Antwerp.

Though the drawing and details show the incoming Renaissance influence, the full continuous narrative arrangement of the group, the strong vertical lines of the figures, and the

simple modeling show the tarrying Gothic feeling. The groups are beautifully massed and the individual figures show great dignity.

22 SWITZERLAND, EARLY XVI CENTURY

TWO PAIRS OF LOVERS: *Two pairs of lovers are pictured against a background of vines with blue-green scrolled leaves and large red and yellow blossoms on a dark-blue field. The pair at the right is on either side of a Gothic pedestal on which is a small statue. The ladies are in red robes. One man is in a blue doublet, the other in a two-toned red brocaded cloak. Border of rose-vines and daisies.*

Wool.
H. 4 ft. 3½ in.
W. 7 ft. 9½ in.

Formerly in the
Collection of
Comtesse Desautoy.

The piece was probably woven in Basle, and is undoubtedly adapted from a wood-block illustration in one of Leonhard Ysenmuth's publications. The width and richness of the border indicate that it was done in the early XVIth rather than in the late XVth century.

The subject of pairs of lovers was quite a favorite one with German and Swiss weavers, and a number of them in different styles is left to us. The piece is probably the work of an amateur, a nun, or more probably some lady, who thus filled her long leisure hours. The wood-block print has been closely followed for the figures, even to such minor details as the very simple conventionalization of the hair. The vine background in rather a large scale is common to many Swiss tapestries of the period. The limited range of colors used is especially worthy of note, there being only three shades of blue, three of green-blue, three of tan, and two of red, in addition to the black for the outlines.

The work is thoroughly naïve, but it has the strong appeal of genuineness and directness common to naïve designs and shows a strong feeling for decorative quality.

Lent by Wildenstein
& Co.

23-25 BRUSSELS, SECOND QUARTER XVI CENTURY

THREE SCENES FROM THE DEEDS OF SCIPIO: *In the first piece (No. 23) Scipio enthroned offers the mural crown to Caius Laelius. Roman army officers stand about. In the background the army is assembled.*

In the second piece (No. 24) Scipio is about to land in Africa. In the foreground two vessels filled with soldiers. In the background the city of Utica.

In the third piece (No. 25) Hannibal approaches Scipio to sue for peace. In the background the opposing armies face each other on either side of a river.

Wool, Silk, Gold.

No. 23:

H. 13 ft. 5 in.

w. 15 ft. 4 in.

No. 24:

H. 13 ft. 5 in.

w. 20 ft.

No. 25:

H. 13 ft. 5 in.

w. 20 ft.

The pieces bear the Brussels city mark and the monogram H.M. (Hubert de Mecht). The cartoons are attributed to Giulio Romano, fifteen of the original small drawings being in the Louvre. There are in all eighteen pieces in this set, and two subsequent sets, the *Triumphs of Scipio* and the *Fruits of War*, make a total of thirty-five pieces in the complete history, one of the largest sequences ever attempted in tapestry.

The cartoons have been woven a number of times and examples have been included in many famous collections, including that of Francis I. These pieces were so rich in gold that they were burned to obtain the metal during the Revolution.

These three pieces are from one of the earliest weavings, and in perfection of execution and sumptuousness of material far surpass most of the renderings, ranking with the greatest productions of the early Renaissance. The use of the metal is particularly effective, occurring as it does in three techniques, plain weaving, basket weaving, which always gives a heavy richness, and couching.

Illustrated: Hauser y Menet, *Los Tapices de la Corona de España*, vol. 2, pl. 93; Burlington, 1916, pp. 58-66, in connection with article by George Leland Hunter, *Scipio Tapestries Now in America*.

Lent by Duveen Brothers.

The borders with the classical allegorical figures under porticos are of a very fine type, following the example set by Raphael in his panels for the *Acts of the Apostles*.

For vividness of illustration, strength and clarity of silhouette, and delicacy and freshness of color this set is nowhere surpassed.



The Triumph of David

No. 21



Two Pairs of Lovers

No. 22

26, 27 BRUSSELS, XVI CENTURY

TWO SCENES FROM THE LIFE OF CYRUS: *In the first (No. 26) Cyrus captures Astyages, his grandfather. Soldiers stand about, and in the background the army is assembled.*

In the second (No. 27) Thomyris has the head of Cyrus offered as a human sacrifice. An attendant is placing the head in a gold basin and soldiers standing about draw back in horror. In the background a battle wages.

These two pieces, showing the moment of greatest triumph and the ultimate defeat of Cyrus, the great world conqueror, are from a famous set that has been woven several times. One of these sets, belonging to the royal family of France, was used in the funeral service of Francis II. Another group from the series is in the Royal Spanish Collection. The only set known with a weaver's signature bears the mark of Nicolas Leyniers, and it is entirely probable that all of the examples, including these two, are from those looms.

They are very fine examples of a type of design perfected in the first half of the XVIth century in Brussels. The fullness of details in the background serves to keep the textile rich and interesting and to throw into sharp silhouette the dominant figures. The intricate and decorative borders that are used on these pieces well illustrate one of the most important contributions of the Renaissance to tapestry design.

Wool and Silk.

No. 26:

H. 12 ft.

W. 15 ft.

No. 27:

H. 12 ft.

W. 16 ft.

Illustrated: *Hauser y Menet, Los Tapices de la Corona de España*, vol. 2, pls. 119, 121.

Lent by Mr. & Mrs. Daniel C. Jackling.

28 BRUSSELS, XVI CENTURY

THE PENTECOST: *The Apostles and the members of the Early Church are gathered together. The tongues of fire descend upon them, and the Holy Ghost appears like a dove between the figures of God and Jesus revealed above. A wide border of scroll with inset medallions of*

Wool and Silk.

H. 8 ft. 10 in.

W. 7 ft. 2 in.

Lent by William Baumgarten & Company.

biblical scenes. In the upper border a papal coat of arms.

Renaissance tapestries in so intimate a scale that yet are not miniature occur rather seldom. The piece has great clarity and brilliance and carries forcefully the religious feeling of the episode.

In the selvage the Brussels city mark and the weaver's initials, C. S. The mark is unidentified.

29 BRUSSELS, XVI CENTURY

JUDITH DEPARTS FOR THE ENEMY'S CAMP: *Judith accompanied by her maid takes leave of her mother. Attendants await to lead her away and a slave awaits in the background holding two camels. Wide border of fruits and flowers.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 6 ft. 9 in.
w. 13 ft. 8 in.

Lent by William
Baumgarten &
Company.

This is one of a very famous set of the *Story of Judith and Holofernes*, examples of which are in a number of famous collections. The tapestry bears on the selvage the Brussels city mark and the weaver's monogram, N. X. The mark is unidentified.

This piece is a strong example of a set that combines characteristic Renaissance stateliness with a less customary direct charm.

30 BRUSSELS, MIDDLE XVI CENTURY

GARDEN SCENE: *Through a trellis upheld by caryatides a formal garden with fountains and pavilions is seen. In the foreground, deer. In the garden, various animals. Border of scrolls and flowers with inset cartouches showing animals.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 11 ft. 3 in.
w. 12 ft. 9 in.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

Such trellis designs as this were quite often used in the middle of the XVIth century. A famous example very similar to this is the *Vertumnus and Pomona* set, one of which was in the Palace of the Escorial and two in the Barberini Collection.^[25] Another piece so like this that it must be the work of the same designer is in the Vienna Collection, number 142.

It is a rich and resourceful kind of decoration well fitted to the requirements of tapestry. The drawing of the deer is unusually graceful and vivacious.

31 FLANDERS, XVI CENTURY

VERDURE: *In the center a château surrounded by a moat on which swans and ducks swim about. At the left fishermen on the bank and a hunter with his dogs. On the right mounted hunters chasing rabbits through a wood.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 5 ft. 9 in.
W. 12 ft. 9 in.

Lent by Mrs.
William H. Crocker.

The high-keyed landscape on a small scale was the Renaissance successor to the Gothic millefleurs. The drawing in this piece is beautifully clean and exact, and the color delightfully and uncommonly varied and vibrant. The château is so carefully rendered that it is valuable as an architectural record. The piece may have been made by Flemish weavers working in England.

32 FLANDERS, LATE XVI CENTURY

HUNTING SCENE: *Hunters riding through a woodland. In the foreground a knight and lady strolling. Scroll border.*

Wool.
H. 9 ft.
W. 23 ft.

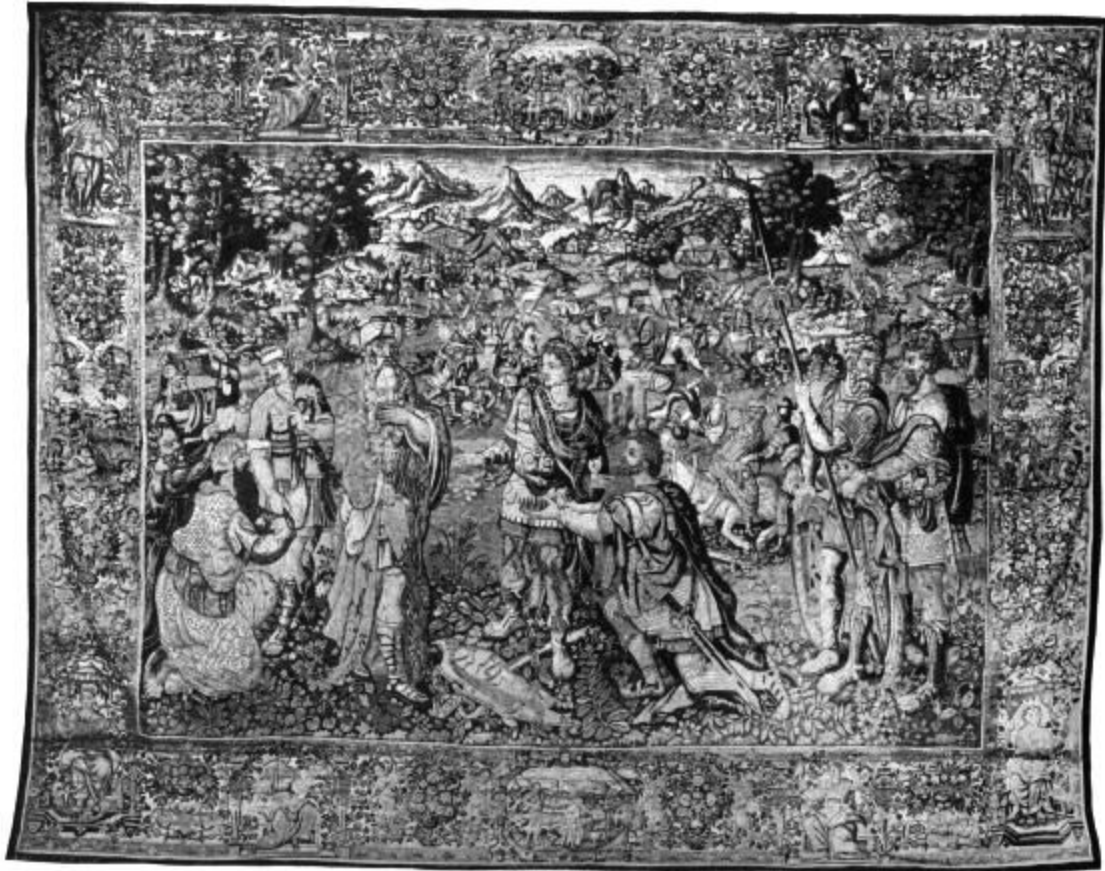
Lent by W. & J.
Sloane.

This piece is a rather uncommon variation of a familiar type. Many tapestries were woven in Flanders in the second part of the XVIth century that were predominantly verdure with a few minor figures, but the figures were seldom as delicately drawn nor the colors so high in key and clear. It is quite possible that the piece was woven by Flemish weavers in England, a few pieces woven there by the Poyntz family being known to have somewhat the same quality. The relatively low height in proportion to the great length also suggests that it was made for an English house.



Hannibal Approaches Scipio to Sue for Peace

No. 25



Cyrus Captures Astyages, His Grandfather

No. 26

33 FLANDERS, ENGHIEN (?), XVI CENTURY

VERDURE: Large scrolling leaves, bluish-green, with bunches of fruit and flowers and small finches. Wide border of fruit and flowers.

Verdures of this type were very much in demand in the Renaissance period. They are typical of the decorative manner of the time and one of its finest inventions.

The heavy, simple leaves are often too obvious and too readily explored for the best tapestry decoration; but in this piece the beautifully drawn birds provide delicacy and interest of detail.

Wool.
H. 9 ft. 7 in.
W. 7 ft. 9 in.

Lent by Dikran K.
Kelekian.

34 BRUGES, MIDDLE XVI CENTURY (1556)

ARMORIAL: *Two amorini support a shield. Above, crossed banners; below, dolphins. Six flags radiate from the shield, each bearing the initial P surmounted by a crown. Border of scrolls and classic figures. In cartouches in the side and lower borders the initials F, G, and X respectively, and in the corresponding cartouche of the top border the date, 1556. On the right lower selvage is the city mark of Bruges, with the weaver's monogram, A. F.* [26]

Wool and Silk.
H. 9 ft. 1 in.
W. 8 ft. 9 in.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

This tapestry is very interesting, not only because it is a clear, strong example of a Renaissance heraldic hanging, but because very few pieces of the period can be ascribed definitely to Bruges although it is known that important looms flourished there. The weaver's monogram has not been identified. The coat of arms, which is also unidentified, seems to be Spanish, and judging by the coronet evidently belonged to a family of high station. The amorini are after a follower of Giulio Romano, if not by Romano himself.

The relief effect of the design is quite extraordinary.

35 BRUSSELS, XVI CENTURY (1574)

THE CRUCIFIXION: *Christ and the two thieves on the crosses. In the foreground, right, the Roman soldiers; left, the sorrowing Marys. Floral border. Dated in cartouche in the border, 1574.*

Wool, Silk, Gold.
H. with frame, 4 ft.
W. with frame, 3 ft.
9 in.

This is one of a number of small tapestries in silk and gold of religious subjects, most of which have been attributed to Bernard Van Orley, who probably designed this piece also. They are all of them very exact reproductions of paintings, remarkable in weave and very beautiful in color. The type was first woven in the first quarter of the XVIth century, and continued to be produced in very limited numbers until well into the XVIIth century. They were undoubtedly woven only for special orders—probably for private chapels.

The piece is a very brilliant example of one of the richest types of tapestry that has ever been woven.

Bernard Van Orley (1492-5 to 1540) was trained by his father, Valentin, and afterwards studied under Raphael in Italy. He was engaged to supervise the translation of Raphael's cartoons for the famous series of the *Apostles* into tapestry. In 1518 he became court painter. He designed many tapestries, of which the most famous are the *Hunts of Maximilian* and the *Victory of Pavia* series.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

36 FONTAINEBLEAU, MIDDLE XVI CENTURY

GROTESQUES: *On a red ground, grotesques, of which the principal features are: in the center Flora in an arbor on the top of which stands Atlas upholding the world; two cartouches left and two right with candelabra and various deities. Below at the left in a small oval medallion Leda and the Swan, and in the corresponding medallion on the other side Eve and the Serpent. The remaining spaces are filled with amorini, garlands of fruit and flowers, gods, and various ornaments. Narrow floral borders, and in the center of both side borders a triangle.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 11 ft.
W. 17 ft.

The triangles in the border are the Deltas, the ciphers of Diane de Poitiers, indicating that this piece was woven in the reign of Henry II for Diane, possibly for the Château d'Anet.

For fertile and varied imagination this piece is quite uncommon even among grotesques, the most imaginative type of decorative tapestries. It exhibits a most entertaining sense of humor and shows a capricious independence never found in the more formal Flemish grotesques of the time.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

37 FONTAINEBLEAU, MIDDLE XVI CENTURY

TRIUMPH OF DIANA: *The goddess in a blue robe, bearing her bow and arrows, drives a pale-blue chariot on which a nymph is tied prisoner. Love, whose wings are beautifully multicolored, also is a prisoner. Diana's attendants, garbed in blue and red tunics, follow on foot, one in the foreground in a green tunic leading a large grey-hound. In the border shells alternate with crescents on a blue ground and in the corners above are crescents and rams' heads. The mottoes "Non Frusta Jupiter Am Bas" and "Sic Immota Manet" are in the upper and lower borders respectively.*^[27]

Wool and Silk.
H. 12 ft. 8 in.
W. 8 ft.

The tapestry was evidently made for Diane de Poitiers, mistress of Henry II, the subject being chosen as a personal tribute.

Aside from its evident beauty, the piece is important because it is one of the few remaining examples of the work of the Fontainebleau looms, which adapted to tapestry the characteristic Italian-French Renaissance decoration that was formulated in the frescoes of Fontainebleau. There are few documents left on these looms, but it is known that le Primatice made designs for tapestries woven there, and, judging from the drawing of the figures with the long limbs and heavily marked muscles that reflect the influence of Michael Angelo, and the contour of the small heads with the hair flowing back and the classical features, together with such other details as the long flexible fingers, this piece would seem to be an example of his work. If not by le Primatice, it was certainly done directly under his influence; but it could scarcely be by Boudouin, judging from the recently discovered set in the Viennese

Formerly in the
Collection of
Edouard Kann,
Paris.

exhibition, [\[28\]](#) for it has more poise and clarity of space than any of those tapestries.



The Crucifixion

No. 35



Grotesques No.

36

For grace and charm, without any loss of strength, this surpasses most French work of the period. It is an unusually typical illustration of the French Renaissance which took the technique of the Italian revival of the antique and refashioned it to her own spirit, giving the classic goddesses, even in their dignity, youthful and feminine appeal, and refining the Italian opulence. The floreation in the foreground is as delicate as in a XVIth-century millefleurs, and the colors are unusually luminous.

Francesco Primaticcio (1504-1570) studied under a disciple of Raphael and worked with Giulio Romano on the decorations of the Palace de Te, Mantua. In 1532 he went from Italy to Fontainebleau to work on the decorations there. In 1540 he returned to Italy to collect works of art for the king. He returned to France and continued to create decorations at Fontainebleau with a large staff of Italian painters as his collaborators. Under Francis II he became Superintendent of the Building.

Lent by Wildenstein
& Company.

38 PARIS, EARLY XVII CENTURY

THE NIOBIDES: *Apollo and Artemis from a cloud shoot down the children of Niobe, thus avenging their mother, who had been outraged by Niobe's boasting that she had the more children. Border of fruit garlands and figures in camaieux.*

Wool.
H. 13 ft.
W. 16 ft. 9 in.

The tapestry is one of the Artemis series designed for Marie de Medici by Toussaint du Breuil. It was woven on the looms which were under the direction of Marc Comans and François de la Planche, and which later became the Gobelins state manufactory. The cartoons were repeated many times with different borders. Judging by the border, this piece was woven about 1611.

The piece is a splendid example of the dramatic and monumental character of the productions of the pre-Gobelins looms.

The sensitive feeling for decorative fitness and the reserve that are evident in French designs from the Gothic period on differentiate such a cartoon as this from the contemporary Flemish productions, usually so violent and exaggerated in scale, in drawing, and in emotional expression. For, though dramatic, the scene is restrained and the figures have an almost sculptural detachment. This quality is sustained by the fine architectural border, which is very typical of the Paris looms of this period.

Formerly in
Marnier-Lapostolle
Collection, Paris.

Reproduced:
*Guiffrey, Les
Gobelins et
Beauvais*, p. 15;
*Hauser y Menet,
Los Tapices de la
Corona de España*,
vol. 2, pl. 132.

Lent by *Jacques
Seligmann &
Company.*

Toussaint du Breuil (1561-1602) painted decorations in the Pavilions des Poêles at Fontainebleau, and also in the Galerie des Rois in the Louvre. Most of his work has perished.

39, 40 GOBELINS, XVI CENTURY

TWO SCENES FROM THE HISTORY OF CLEOPATRA: *In the first (No. 39) Cleopatra attended by two maidens greets a young prince who is being introduced to her by a general. In the harbor the young stranger's ship is seen.*

Wool and Silk.
No. 39:
H. 7 ft. 9 in.
W. 13 ft. 6 in.
No. 40:

In the second (No. 40) Cleopatra welcomes a young man. An attendant holds a heavy canopy of silk. Beyond, a Greek temple is seen.

H. 7 ft. 9 in.
W. 11 ft.

Side borders, only, of classic decorations on a red ground with inset medallions showing the Judgment of Paris.

The pieces both signed in the lower right corner—Lefébvre, with the fleur-de-lis and G. They do not, however, appear on the records of the Gobelins, so they must have been done by Lefébvre outside of the official work.

Formerly in the
Collection of Lord
Lovelace.

Lent by *William
Baumgarten &
Company.*

They are strong and fresh examples of the early work of the Gobelins weavers, and typical of the classicism of the late Renaissance in France. The requirements of mural decoration are met by the monumental character and sculptural poise of the figures, but at the same time the design is adapted to a decorative textile through the perfection of the detail and the richness of the colors.

41 FLANDERS, BEGINNING OF XVII CENTURY

VERDURE: A formal garden with fountains and a château in the distance and various birds in the foreground.

Wool and Silk.
H. 7 ft. 10 in.
W. 13 ft. 4 in.

Such landscape tapestries were a characteristic late Renaissance interpretation of the verdure type, a transition between the Gothic *millefleurs*, that were really originally landscapes without perspective (cf. No. 11), and the XVIIth-century verdures (cf. No. 43). It is a very successful form of verdure, for they are broadly effective from a distance and yet have a sufficient wealth of detail to yield interest on closer exploration. The birds in this piece are especially carefully observed and well drawn, and the purity and vivacity of the color is exceptional for this type.

Lent by *Mrs. C.
Templeton Crocker.*

42 BRUSSELS, LATE XVII CENTURY

AMERICA: *In a tropical landscape an Indian with bow and arrows caressing a crocodile. Two children beside him smoking pipes. In the background on a hill a mission; in the foreground a heap of fruits and flowers and precious objects symbolic of the wealth of the New World. Border of fruits and flowers with corner medallions representing North, East, South, and West. On the lower selvage the Brussels city mark and the signature, I. V. D. BEURCHT.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 13 ft.
W. 12 ft.

The piece is one of a set of four representing the four quarters of the globe. It was woven by Jean Van der Beurcht, one of the great weavers of Brussels, who is known to have been working there between 1690 and 1710. The Van der Beurcht family had for several generations been painters, Jean being the first to turn from that profession to tapestry weaving. He was followed by several other members of the family (cf. No. 56), all of whom did work of the highest quality.

Another example in
Musée Impériale
des Ecuries,
Petrograd, No. 117.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

The piece is a splendid illustration of the romantic attitude toward America at the time and a reminder of the importance America had to Europeans as a source of wealth. The mission on the hill, and another mission settlement in the valley of which a glimpse can be caught, are of especial interest.

43 FLANDERS, XVII CENTURY

VERDURE WITH BEAR HUNT: *In a forest of large trees hunters shooting and spearing bears. In place of a border, large columns at the sides with floral garlands hung between them across the top.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 11 ft. 10 in.
W. 11 ft.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

The piece is a type of verdure, numbers of which with many variations were produced in Flanders during the XVIIth century. It is one of a set of five, and is a very strong, fresh example.

The substitution of massive columns for formal borders is characteristic of the Baroque period and serves the better to adapt the tapestry to the prevailing architecture.

44 BRUSSELS, XVII CENTURY

TRIUMPH OF AUGUSTUS AND LIVIA: *Caesar offers the crown of victory to Augustus, who kneels before him. He is surrounded by his attendants and his chariot waits in the background. The side borders are of flower-draped columns, top and bottom borders of fruit and flower garlands, with ornaments. On the side borders are cartouches bearing the insignia: Pax. Aug. and Vic. Aug. (Pax Augusta and Victoria Augusta).*

Wool and Silk.
H. 11 ft.
W. 18 ft. 8 in.

From the Morgan Collection, No. 17.
Another example in the Swedish Royal Collection.

The piece is one of a series on the *History of Julius Caesar*, three of which were in the Morgan Collection. It has all the abundance and dramatic emphasis characteristic of the Baroque period.

The massive yet active figures, the large folded, swinging drapes, the luxurious and heavy accessories are all typical of the work of a time when the large, the impressive, and the elaborate were sought in all forms of art. The manner was introduced into tapestry cartoons by Rubens and carried on by many of his pupils and imitators. Even the outline of the composition of this piece follows closely that of Rubens' famous *Triumphs*, from which the suggestion for the cartoon was undoubtedly taken.

Illustrated:
Böttiger, Svenska Statins Samling,
vol. 3, pl. XLII.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

45 FLANDERS, XVII CENTURY

THE VIRGIN AND CHILD: *The Virgin in a pale red gown with a dark-blue cloak falling about her is seated on the ground. The child holding a staff in the form of a cross sits on her knee. Beyond is a castle, and against the sky a high mountain. Wide floral border. The high lights are in gold.*

Wool, Silk, Gold.
H. 3 ft. 1 in.
W. 4 ft.

Lent by Duveen
Brothers.

This is a most exceptional piece of tapestry, evidently made to special order, probably for a private chapel, after an Italian Renaissance painting. The excessive fineness of the weave and the unstinted use of gold to render the high lights indicate that it was made for a person of wealth and importance.

The painting is faithfully and delicately reproduced and the border is remarkably rich and glowing.

46 BRUSSELS, LATE XVII, EARLY XVIII CENTURY

SANCHO IS TOSSED IN A BLANKET: *Sancho, following Don Quixote's example, has refused to pay the innkeeper, as that is against the tradition of knights-errant and their squires. So the clothmakers of Segovia and the needlemakers of Cordova who chance to be there toss him in a blanket, while Don Quixote sits without on his horse cursing lustily.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 12 ft.
W. 17 ft. 6 in.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

The piece is one of a set of illustrations of *Don Quixote* after David Teniers the Younger. The scene has all the casual and convincing informality and boisterous good spirits for which Teniers' paintings are famous. It quite catches the spirit of the romance which it illustrates. The landscape vista is unusually lovely in color.

David Teniers the Younger (1610-1694) was trained principally under his father, David the Elder, also famous for paintings of peasant episodes. In 1633 he became Master of the Guild of St. Luke's, and thereafter was Dean of the Guild and painter to the governor, Archduke Leopold William, a position which he continued to hold under the next governor, Don Juan of Austria. In 1663 he helped form the Antwerp Academy of Fine Arts. He painted innumerable pictures of peasant scenes, many of which have been rendered in tapestry.

47, 48 BRUSSELS, XVIII CENTURY

TWO PEASANT SCENES: *In the first (No. 47) a group of peasants has stopped to rest and talk beside a stream that comes tumbling down in broken cascades beneath a high stone bridge. On the hills in the background are farmhouses and the ruins of castles.*

Wool and Silk.
No. 47:
H. 11 ft.
W. 8 ft. 9 in.
No. 48:
H. 11 ft.

In the second (No. 48) a group of peasants sits and stands about under a tree in a meadow, in which cattle and goats wander. In the background is a farmhouse.

w. 8 ft. 9 in.

Lent by Duveen
Brothers.

These tapestries after Teniers are typical of his illustrations of life among the peasants and of his decorative and romantic yet realistic landscapes. They are in weaving and color of the best quality of examples of this type.



Triumph of Diana

No. 37



The Niobides

No. 38

49 MORTLAKE, LATE XVII CENTURY

PEASANTS IN A LANDSCAPE: *A group of peasants has stopped by the wayside in a mountainous landscape. Above is a shield bearing the inscription "Iocatur in Parvis sorts ut cum Magna Mercede Fallat."*

The cartoon is after Teniers. The Mortlake renditions of these cartoons, which were borrowed from Flanders, have a clarity and sharpness that give them marked distinction. The towering mountain landscape is really impressive.

The rendition of the water is unusually realistic without any loss of decorative interest. The translation of water into a woven design is one of the most difficult problems of the craft. It has been given many solutions, of which this is the most naturalistic.

Wool and Silk.
H. 10 ft. 4 in.
W. 7 ft. 6 in.

Formerly in the
Collection of Sir
John Ramsay.

Lent by Frank
Partridge, Inc.

50 BEAUVAIS, LATE XVII CENTURY

HERMES AND THE SHEPHERD: *Hermes has taken the Shepherd's pipe, leaving the caduceus on the ground, and is attempting to play. They are in a wood with large flowers in the foreground. In the background there is a glimpse of a hilly landscape and a formal garden with fountains. Wide floral border.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 10 ft.
W. 8 ft. 8 in.

Lent by Mrs. James
Creelman.

The piece is one of a set of five verdures, most of which have hunting scenes. While there is no signature, and there are no records on them, the character of the foliage and of the floreation makes it almost certain that these are of Beauvais manufacture. While in some details they resemble contemporary Aubusson tapestries, the quality of the color is rather different.

They are a particularly deep and quiet type of verdure, an excellent background for fine furnishings. The quality of the greens is uncommonly fine.

51 BEAUVAIS, BEGINNING OF XVIII CENTURY

VERDURE WITH DANCING NYMPHS: *In a wooded dell are four nymphs dancing. Beyond is a glimpse of an open pasture with cows.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 10 ft. 9 in.
W. 13 ft. 3 in.

Lent by Dikran K.
Kelekian.

The strong and brilliant trees throw into sharp contrast the delicate perfection of the bit of landscape beyond. The nymphs are probably after Noël Coypel. The use of the red to relieve the general tone of green is especially successful.

52 BEAUVAIS, 1685-1711

THE CONQUEST OF LOUIS THE GREAT: *Louis XIV on horseback with two attendants points with his cane to the siege of a city whose defenses are surrounded by*

Wool, Silk, Gold.
H. 15 ft. 8 in.
W. 11 ft. 10 in.

water. In the upper border appear the arms of Count Bruhl of Saxony. The piece is one of a set of seven.

This is a very rare example from one of the earliest sets woven at Beauvais when the factory was under the direction of Behagle. The cartoon was designed either by Van der Meulen or his greatest pupil, Jean-Baptiste Martin, later called Martin of the Battles, because of a famous series of cartoons which he made for the Beauvais works illustrating the victories of Sweden over Denmark.

The richness of the king's group stands out brilliantly against the clear, cool color and sharp geometrical lines of the background. The city with its canals and buildings is exquisitely rendered, an interesting anticipation of an aeroplane view.

Adam Frans Van der Meulen (1632-1690) was a native of Brussels and studied there under Peter Snayers, but on recommendation of Le Brun was invited by Colbert to Paris, where he was pensioned by the king and given apartments in the Gobelins. In 1673 he was received into the Academy. He collaborated with Le Brun in making designs for the Gobelins, notably for the series of *The History of the King*.

53-56 BRUSSELS, BEGINNING XVIII CENTURY

THE OPERATIONS OF THE SIEGE OF LILLE:
Number 53 represents the battle of Wynendael Wood. Lord Cobham on horseback with his sword drawn is in the midst of his troops.

Number 54 shows the burning of Lille. The burning city is seen in the background. Soldiers in the foreground are getting bundles of wood to feed the flames.

Number 55 shows cavaliers foraging. Soldiers are carrying bundles of hay for their horses and a lamb lies on the ground ready to be carried off.

Formerly in the
Lord Amherst
Collection.

Illustrated: *Badin*,
*La Manufacture de
la Tapisserie de
Beauvais*, opp. p. 4.

Lent by *P. W.
French &
Company*.

Wool.
No. 53:
H. 10 ft. 7 in.
W. 29 ft.
No. 54:
H. 10 ft. 4 in.
W. 9 ft. 4 in.
No. 55:
H. 10 ft. 3½ in.
W. 7 ft. 2 in.
No. 56:
H. 10 ft. 4½ in.
W. 7 ft. 3 in.

Number 56 shows the poisoning of a spy. The cavaliers have just given a glass of poisoned wine to a young woman who is about to drink.

The borders simulate wooden frames and carry the arms of Lord Cobham.

Formerly in Stowe House.

Lent by Jacques Seligmann & Company.

The set was designed by Van der Meulen for Lord Cobham, who served under the Duke of Marlborough and had a brilliant military career. It was woven at the Royal Manufactory of Brussels under the direction of Leyniers, whose signature appears in the border of three pieces. In the fourth piece is the signature ACASTRO, Latin for Van der Beurcht.

Cobham inherited Stowe House in 1697, and these tapestries until recently hung in the dining-room there.

The set ranks with the strongest and most effective pieces of the period, rich both in illustrative action and in decoration. The weave is technically perfect.

57 GOBELINS, MIDDLE XVIII CENTURY (1747-1751)

JULY FROM THE "MONTHS" OF LUCAS: *From a series of designs of the Months, used in Brussels since the XVth century and attributed without verification to Lucas Van Leyden. The scene represents a falconing party.*

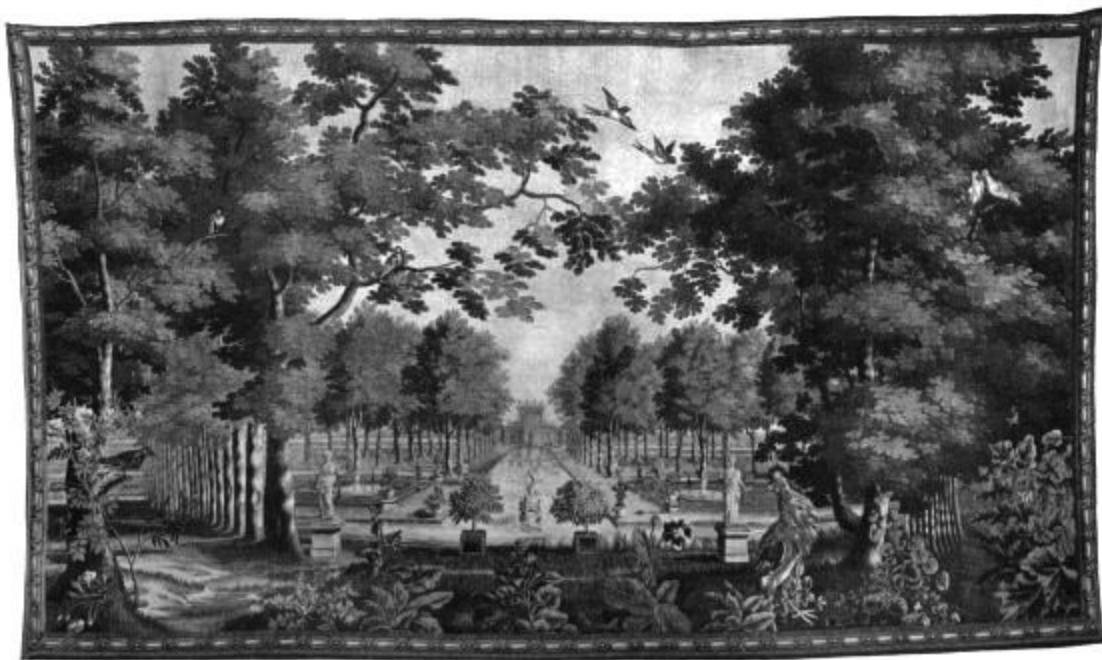
Wool and Silk.
H. 11 ft. 6 in.
W. 8 ft. 3 in.



Scene from the History of Cleopatra

39

No.



Verdure

No. 41

The piece has the last type of border used for the set, the so-called Dresden border, representing a carved and gilded wood frame with corner ornaments

surrounded by naturalistic flowers, and with a sign of the Zodiac (Leo) in a cartouche at the top.

The piece was probably woven in the tenth weaving between 1741 and 1751 on the upright looms in the atelier of Cozette. ^[29]

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

This is an unusually clear and brilliant example of a famous Gobelins set.

58 GOBELINS, XVII CENTURY

DECEMBER FROM THE "MONTHS" OF LUCAS: *A nobleman greets a peasant woman and her child, while a man and woman carrying a baby wait for him. In the background a castle and people skating on the ice. The piece is incomplete.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 9 ft. 4 in.
W. 6 ft. 8 in.

Another example in
the Vienna
Collection, No. 109.

Lent by Wildenstein
& Company.

This tapestry is from the same set as the preceding, but woven almost a century earlier, and it is interesting to contrast the changes that the change in taste has made in the feeling of the rendition and the color key. During the XVIIIth century the cartoon was refined with slight changes. The hand of the old man, for example, was modified to hold a fruit for the child. The piece probably is from the third or fourth weaving. If so, it was done on the horizontal looms in the atelier of Lefévre, outside of the official work of the Gobelins. ^[30]

This is one of the few really successful renditions of a snow scene in tapestry.

59 BEAUVAIS, LATE XVII, EARLY XVIII CENTURY (1684-1711)

CHINESE GROTESQUE: *Under an arbor clowns conduct a circus. Above the arbor are scrolls, garlands, birds, musical instruments, and other decorations. On a yellow ground.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 9 ft. 8 in.
W. 16 ft. 5 in.

This is one of a famous series of grotesques by Berain on a yellow ground, woven several times at the Beauvais works when they were under the direction of Behagle.

[\[31\]](#)

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

The entertaining fantasy of the conception, together with the delicate drawing and the beautiful ground color, makes this one of the finest grotesques of the XVIIIth century.

Jean Berain (1638-1711) was appointed in 1674 designer to the king, and in this position designed the scenery and costumes for the court ballets. He is famous for his decorations.

60, 61 BEAUVAIS, XVIII CENTURY

TWO STILL-LIFE PIECES: *In one (No. 60) a glass, a napkin, and some vegetables on a table. In the other (No. 61) various vegetables about a china dish.*

These panels, after paintings by Chardin, are the only recorded examples of still-life composition in tapestry. From the middle of the XVth century household utensils and various other types of accessories were used to contribute richness of ornamentation to scenes, and during the Baroque period embossed metals and lavish carvings became especially important in creating a luxurious effect, but not until tapestry was thought of as a form of painting was a purely still-life subject attempted. All still-life designs depend so much on contrasted weights, and especially on textures, that they are particularly difficult to translate into a medium which, like tapestry, renders primarily silhouettes and which has such a decided texture of its own. But the extraordinary skill of the XVIIIth-century French weavers was equal even to that problem. The skillful care of the composition of the original paintings and the pure beauty of the colors of the tapestry make of rather unpromising subjects beautiful decorations.

Wool and Silk.

No. 60:

H. 15½ in.

w. 19 in.

No. 61:

H. 15½ in.

w. 19 in.

Lent by Maison
Jamarin, Paris.

Jean Siméon Chardin (1699-1779) studied under Noël Coypel and assisted Jean Baptiste Van Loo in restoring one of the galleries of

Fontainebleau. He was admitted to the Academy in 1728. His early work was devoted to still-life subjects principally, his later to peasant scenes, in which there are often fine incidental still lifes.

62 AUBUSSON, MIDDLE XVIII CENTURY

THE PRIEST AND CARDENIO MEET DOROTHY:

The priest and the barber while looking for Don Quixote come across Cardenio. While Cardenio is telling them the sad story of how his love, Lucinda, has been stolen from him by the treachery of Don Fernando they hear someone lamenting. Following the sound of the voice, they find Dorothy disguised as a shepherd-boy bathing her feet in a stream. She is on her way to seek Don Fernando, who is her pledged husband and who has deserted her for Lucinda. In the background Don Quixote, exhausted and starved from his wanderings, lies on the ground, while the faithful Sancho pleads with him to return to Toboso.

Wool and Silk.

H. 9 ft. 8 in.

W. 10 ft. 9 in.

The border simulates a carved frame. On the lower selvage is the signature M. R. DAUBUSSON. MAGE. PICON.

The piece is one of a series of illustrations by Coypel, originally designed for the Gobelins, and was engraved and used in many editions of the romance both in France and Spain. Several looms made tapestries after the engravings, including those of Santa Barbara in Madrid.

The signature is the mark of the royal manufacture of Aubusson, and of Mage, a tapestry merchant in Paris in 1746, and Picon, dyer to the king from 1748 to 1756. The piece was evidently made in the royal works of Aubusson to the order of the dealer Mage under the supervision of Picon, who, from his position, was evidently one of the most important members of the staff there.



Verdure with Dancing Nymphs

No. 51



The Conquest of Louis The Great
52

No.

The piece shows Aubusson work at its richest and finest. The foliage of the trees with every leaf shown and broken up into small spots of changing color is very typical of Aubusson, and quite different from the manner of the Flemish shops (cf. No. 55). The colors are remarkably fine.

Charles Antoine Coypel (1694-1752) entered the Academy in 1715, and the next year made a series of twenty-eight designs illustrating *Don Quixote* for the Gobelins. A second important series which he designed for the Gobelins illustrated scenes from the theatre. He was a favorite painter of Queen Marie Leczinska. He wrote several comic dramas and had an interest in an understanding of the theatre which is

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

reflected in his tapestry designs, which are conceived always as a theatrical scene in a stage setting, with actors making the proper expressive gestures.

63 PARIS, XVIII CENTURY

BACCHANTE: *A young bacchante wearing a tigerskin and holding Pan's pipes. In an oval panel.*

This panel is after a portrait by Coypel. Though it does not appear on the official registers of the Gobelins, the technique would indicate that it was probably by a Gobelins weaver, who quite often worked outside of the official orders.

Wool and Silk.

Oval;

H. 28 in.

w. 23 in.

Lent by Jacques
Seligmann &
Company.

The delicate execution reproduces faithfully the piquant charm of the painting; even the most delicate gradations of tones are exactly reproduced.

64. GOBELINS, XVIII CENTURY

PORTRAIT OF LOUIS XV: *This portrait, after a painting by Van Loo made for the Gobelins in 1760, is one of a series of the royal family. It is in the original frame.*

While tapestry is not an appropriate medium for portraiture, a portrait is the supreme test of the skill of the weaver. In this piece the effect of the painting is reproduced with remarkable fidelity. The warp is vertical.

The technical difficulty was the greater because almost the entire piece was woven in wool, the proper material for tapestry, silk being relied on only for a few high lights. As a portrait it has directness and conviction, carrying the essential dignity of royalty. The XVIIIth century, which first undertook to weave tapestry portraits, produced a kind of portrait that was especially ill-adapted to this material; for the likenesses depended

Wool and Silk.

H. 25 in.

w. 21 in.

Illustrated: Böttiger,
Svenska Statins
Samling, vol. 2, pl.
XLI; Fénaillé, *Etat*
général des
Tapisseries de la
Manufacture des
Gobelins, Dix-
huitième Siècle,
2^{me} Partie, p. 311;
as portrait of Louis
XVI, in Migeon,
Les Arts de Tissue, p.
335.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

primarily on the delicate modeling produced by a very sensitively differentiated scale of values and scarcely at all on lines. Even in Gothic tapestries there are many heads that are striking portraits, but these are entirely graphic in character and so fitted for tapestry. In rendering this portrait the weavers had literally to paint with the shuttle.

Carle Van Loo (1705-1756) studied in Rome under Luti and Le Gros. In his youth he painted scenery for the opera with Boucher. In 1737 he was admitted to the Academy, and in 1762 made first painter to the king.

65 GOBELINS, FIRST HALF XVIII CENTURY

THE INDIAN HUNTER: *This tapestry is one of a set of eight illustrating the New India after designs by François Desportes. The set was first woven in 1687. This piece has the first type of border used with the series, bearing the arms of the king, which means that it was woven before 1768 under either Cozette or Neilson.* [\[32\]](#)

The design is typical of the romantic primitivism that Rousseau formulated in his conception of the Noble Savage. The accuracy of detail in the Indian basket is interesting and rather unexpected.

Wool.
H. 13 ft. 3 in.
W. 8 ft. 3 in.

Another rendering in the Vienna Collection, No. 253; another in the Musée Impériale des Ecuries, Petrograd, No. 118.

Lent by Demotte.

François Desportes (1661-1743) studied under Bernaert, a pupil of Snyder. He entered the Academy in 1699 and was made painter to the king. He is famous for his paintings of animals and hunting scenes.

66 BEAUVAIS, XVIII CENTURY (1777)

THE THEFT OF THE TRUNK: *A group of gypsies surround a traveler's carriage, and while some tell the lady's fortune and receive alms others attempt to steal a trunk from the baggage-rack behind.*

Wool.
H. 11 ft. 1 in.
W. 21 ft. 3 in.

Formerly in Collection of Count

The tapestry is one of the series *Les Bohémiens* by François Casanova, and was woven in Beauvais when the factory was under the direction of André Charlemagne Charron, whose initials it bears in signature. According to the inventories, the series has been woven only twice—once in 1777 for the king, and again in 1799.^[33]

Polovzoff, Petrograd. Another example in the Swedish Royal Collection. Illustrated: Böttiger, *Svenska Statins Samling*, vol. 3, pl. LXVI.

Lent by Jacques Seligmann & Company.

The vividness of the minor episodes and the vivacity of characterization of even the lesser actors make this a most interesting tapestry. The weaving is done with exquisite skill and the color is unusually fresh and charming.

François Casanova (1730-1805) went to Italy in 1727 where he studied under Guardi and Francesco Simonini. He returned to France and later studied under Parocel. In 1763 he was received into the Academy and exhibited in the salons until 1783.

67 BEAUVAIS, XVIII CENTURY (1735-1740)

THE ARMS OF FRANCE AND NAVARRE: *Two angels on clouds support the coat of arms before an ermine drape against a ground of fleur-de-lis on blue.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 11 ft. 9 in.
W. 14 ft. 6 in.

The angels are after Boucher, the only coat of arms in tapestry known to which Boucher has contributed. It is evidently one of several fleur-de-lis pieces listed in the accounts of Beauvais between 1735 and 1740 and may be the one made for the Parliament of Rouen in the latter year.^[34]

Lent by P. W. French & Company.

It is an unusually rich and interesting armorial, the angels with their characteristic Boucher grace adding great beauty to the formal setting.

François Boucher (1703-1770) studied with Lemoyne and during that time painted scenery for the Opera, a work to which he returned in the height of his career (1737-44). In 1734 he became Academician. In 1735 he was appointed head of the Gobelins by Marigny. In 1765 he was made first painter to the king and Director of the Academy. In the

years between 1740 and 1755 he painted many cartoons for the Beauvais tapestry works. Among his most famous tapestry suites are the *Loves of the Gods*, the *Chinese Hangings*, and the *Italian Fêtes*.

68 GOBELINS, XVIII CENTURY (1767)

THE FORTUNE-TELLER: *Two peasant girls seated on the ground by a fountain are having their fortune told by another girl. A naked baby clings to her skirts. From one side a goat looks on inquisitively. It is signed F. Boucher and dated.*

This is one of a series of cartoons in small size made by Boucher for the Gobelins while he was director. They were very popular and have been woven a number of times.

The piece shows how remarkably the delicate gradations of tone, on which Boucher's essential quality depended, could be translated into the weave by the extraordinarily skillful craftsmen of the Gobelins.

As in all of Boucher's cartoons, the subject is only an occasion for his own charming decorative mannerisms. As a rendition of peasant life, it is interesting to contrast this cartoon with the honest literalness of Teniers (cf. Nos. 47-49).

Wool and Silk.

H. 4 ft. 11 in.

W. 6 ft. 6 in.

Illustrated:
*Fénaille, L'Etat
général des
Tapisseries de la
Manufacture des
Gobelins, Dix-
huitième Siècle,
2me Partie, p. 238.*

Lent by Duveen
Brothers.

69 AUBUSSON, LATE XVIII CENTURY

BAIGNEUSE: *A bather attended by amorini is about to step into a woodland stream. In an oval frame surrounded by an encadrement of garlands upheld by amorini and satin drapes in the manner of Huet, on a gray ground.*

The central panel is after Fragonard, a subject that he repeated with many variations. The piece is typical of the Aubusson work, delicate in color with the decorative effect depending largely on the flowery encadrement.

Wool and Silk.

H. 9 ft. 10 in.

W. 7 ft. 5 in.

Lent by P. W.
French &
Company.

Jean Honoré Fragonard (1732-1806) studied under Boucher, Greuze, and Chardin, and is usually considered the successor of Boucher. In 1752 he was given Grand Prize for Painting. He was a favorite painter of Madame Du Barry, for whom he did a great deal of work.

70 AUBUSSON, LATE XVIII CENTURY

AU BORD DU MER: *In an oval panel are peasants landing from a rowboat. In the harbor under a cliff is a sailing vessel. In an encadrement of red and blue flowers and ribbons on a gray ground.*

The central panel is after Vernet, who was particularly famous for his port scenes. The encadrement is unusually rich and delicate.

Claude-Joseph Vernet (1714-1789) first studied under his father as a decorative painter of wall and furniture panels. Afterward he studied under Bernardino Fergiori in Rome to be a marine painter. In 1735 he was received by the Academy. His most famous paintings, of the seaports of France, are in the Louvre.

Wool and Silk.
H. 8 ft. 10 in.
W. 6 ft. 6 in.

Formerly in the
Vaffrin Collection,
Bordeaux.

Lent by Wildenstein
& Company.

71 AUBUSSON, XVIII CENTURY

CHINESE GROTESQUE: *A Chinaman, fantastically dressed, stands between two tall tropical trees. On a pale-blue ground.*

The piece is a delightful example of the taste for *chinoiserie* which the Pompadour fostered for the benefit of the French East India Company, in which she was interested, and which taste was eagerly followed by the frivolous and bored French court, always seeking novelty.

Wool.
H. 9 ft.
W. 5 ft.

Lent by A. J.
Halow.

72 AUBUSSON, XVIII CENTURY

ARMORIAL: *On a red ground, two angels support a shield. Border of scrolls.*

This crisp and delicate little armorial is a fine example of the best quality of work done at Aubusson in the late XVIIIth century. The clear drawing on the deep-red background makes a vivid piece of decoration.

The rendition of a coat of arms in tapestry is difficult, because the decorative value of heraldic devices depends almost entirely on the beauty of the line-drawing, and tapestry, because of the character of the weave and the surface, is not a good medium for clean lines. In the earlier periods, therefore, the shield was usually made incidental to a design better adapted to tapestry (cf. No. 9). It was only well into the XVIIIth century that the bearings could be woven delicately enough to let them stand alone.

Wool and Silk.

H. 4 ft. 3 in.

W. 3 ft. 9 in.

Exhibited: *Detroit Museum of Fine Arts*, 1919.

Lent by *Dikran K. Kelekian*.

73 IMPERIAL RUSSIAN TAPESTRY WORKS, ST. PETERSBURG, 1811

CATHERINE THE GREAT: *Catherine stands in her robes of state holding the sceptre while the Imperial crown rests on a stool beside her. On the wall is the Russian motto, NACHATOYE SOVERCHAYET ("What is begun is accomplished"). It is signed and dated.*

For sheer technical skill the rendition of this portrait is unsurpassable. The representation of textures is remarkable, quite on a par with the cleverest paintings of the period.

Wool and Silk.

H. 9 ft. 4 in.

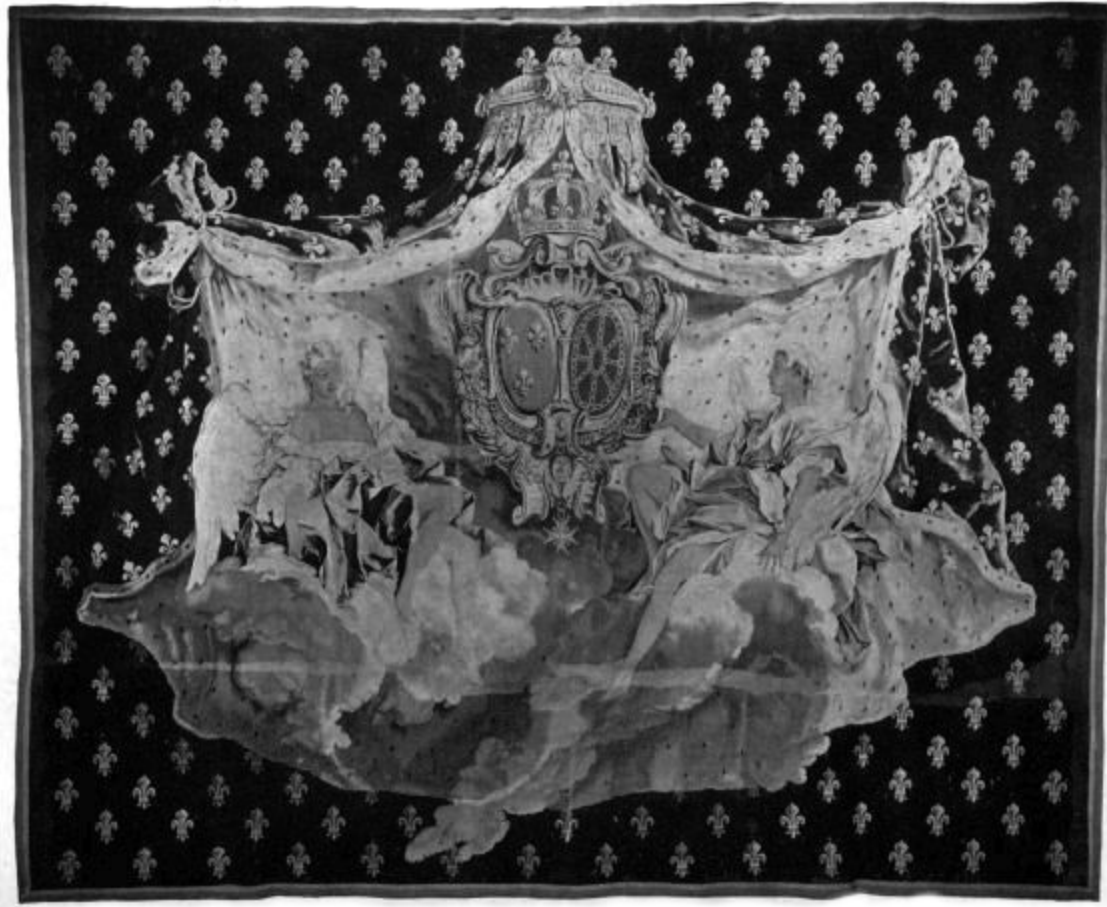
W. 6 ft. 7 in.

Exhibited: *Metropolitan Museum*, 1912.



The Poisoning of a Spy

No. 56



The Arms of France and Navarre

No. 67

It is, in truth, an absolutely perfect reproduction of a painting—a painting, moreover, that from the character of all the accessories is particularly difficult to render in wool; and while it is by no means the business of tapestry to imitate painting, it is nevertheless an interesting display of remarkable virtuosity. The personal power of the forceful old Empress is strongly presented. From every aspect this is one of the greatest portraits in a woven medium. In general color tone the piece has remained faithful to the character of tapestry, sustaining the rich quality that the solid texture demands. In spite, also, of the need for many delicately graded values to render the stuffs and the modeling, the weavers have kept the color in large enough masses to be broadly decorative.

Illustrated: *Hunter, Tapestries*, pl. 229; also, *Candee, Tapestry Book*, opp. p. 133,—but wrongly attributed to the Gobelins.

Lent by P. W. French & Company.

74 MADRID, LATE XVIII CENTURY

THE CARD PLAYERS: *A group of men and women playing at cards sit about a table on which is thrown a rich brocade. One of the company sits to one side playing a lute.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 5 ft.
W. 8 ft.

Lent by Duveen
Brothers.

This piece is one of the rather uncommon examples of the work of the Santa Barbara looms of Madrid. The skill of the weavers is remarkable in reproducing the heavy modeling of the deep shadows and the delicate modulations of the faces. For the perfect rendition of the effect of a painting in tapestry it cannot be excelled.

ADDENDA

The tapestries entered under this heading were received too late to be entered in their proper order in the body of the catalogue.

75 BRUSSELS, BEGINNING OF XVI CENTURY

THE RESURRECTION: *The risen Christ discovered by Peter. Upper left, the Agony in Gethsemane; upper right, Christ appearing to Mary in the garden. In the background, the angel appearing to the three women. Border of fruits and flowers, grapes, roses, and iris interspersed with finches and a paroquet.*

Wool, Silk, Gold.
H. 9 ft. 1 in.
W. 7 ft. 8 in.

This tapestry, the last of a series illustrating the *Passion* of Our Lord, was designed in the studio of Bernard Van Orley, and may be the work of Van Orley himself, though there were some of his students and followers who in purity of conception and elevation and sensitiveness of feeling were superior at times to the master himself. The weaving, unsurpassable in technical perfection, may be the work of the Pannemaker looms. The quality of the design and weaving and the lavish use of gold all indicate that this series was made for a great church or a noble family.

The weavers at this period had attained complete mastery of the shuttle. This absolute technical control made possible the exact translation into tapestry of the intricate Renaissance patterns. The finish and elegance of the goldsmith's art which characterized so much of Renaissance design is perfectly rendered.

Formerly in the
Collection of the
Duc d'Albe.

However, while the weaving was fitted to the requirements of the Renaissance at this time, it had not yet sacrificed any of its qualities as tapestry. Nor did the designs of Bernard Van Orley force the weavers out of their proper limitations. For though he was Italian trained and saturated with Renaissance influences, he was still close to the technical problems of the weaver's art and he adjusted the new manner in painting to them. So this piece is rich in jewel-like detail that enriches without crowding the whole surface. The drawing of the flowers and the birds is exquisite. The figures also, in spite of their dramatic force, keep the aloof poise that decorative art demands. Finally, by means of a dispersion of substantial tones, the brilliant suffusion of golden light which the Renaissance loved is fully achieved.

Such a scene as this is, in short, one of the last great monuments of the perfection of Gothic tapestry, re-inspired by the new insights of the Renaissance before the ostentation and mistaken conventions of Raphael misguided the entire art.

Nor is it merely a technical triumph. It is the direct expression of a profound religious emotion which shines through the material beauty, elevates it above earthly things, and sets it apart in glory. Easter has scarce had a lovelier celebration.

Lent by Mrs.
William H. Crocker.

76 BRUSSELS, XVI CENTURY

THE TRIUMPH OF WISDOM: *Wisdom with her two herons rides in a chariot drawn by mythological beasts. In the upper right are Perseus and Pegasus. Before the chariot are Ahasuerus, Abigail, David, and Saba. Cassandra walks beside, while Titus and his soldiers, Rachel, and Judith with the head of Holofernes bring up the rear. In the upper left Prometheus, in the lower Cadmus, contending with the dragons.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 15 ft.
W. 19 ft.

This is one of a very famous set of tapestries illustrating the *Triumphs of Petrarch* and a number of other *Triumphs* invented by French poets in imitation of Petrarch. The cartoons are evidently the product of the studio of Maître Philippe (cf. Nos. 19, 20), for the heads of several of the minor characters are regular models, often repeated in his work. The cartoons were painted and also executed before 1523, because in that year Henry VII bought eight of the set, four of which are still at Hampton Court. This piece, however, was woven in the middle of the century, as is shown by the character of the heavy floral border. In the selvage is the Brussels city mark and the mark of the Brussels weaver, Leo Van den Hecke.

The design is full of the oblique symbolism that the period loved. The allusions are drawn with equal interest from classic tradition, secular history, and Christian legend. The entire past has been laid under tribute with magnificent disregard of historical, social, and religious congruity. Such an unclassified assemblage of exciting personalities might even cause confusion in the Day of Judgment. It is typical of the Renaissance catholicity, the Renaissance eagerness to assimilate all knowledge and be always as impressive as possible. Yet the figures still have some of the stately restraint of the Gothic, and the dispersion of the points of interest, so that the whole textile is equally covered, is a remainder from the Gothic taste. Truly transitional, it represents the final stage of Maître Philippe's development.

Lent by Mrs.
William H. Crocker.

77 FLANDERS, ENGHIEEN (?), XVI CENTURY

VERDURE: *Scrolling leaves in rich blue-green with red and yellow flowers and fruits on a very deep-blue ground. A wide border of clusters of flowers and fruits.*

This is a notably brilliant example of the characteristic Renaissance verdure. The drawing is both accurate and vivacious, the colors pure, deep, and brilliant, the wool of extraordinary firmness and lustre, while the weave is remarkably close for the type. Tapestries of this class are so often perfunctory in conception and mechanical in execution that we need a piece of this clarity, strength, and perfect finish to show how splendid are the possibilities inherent in the simple design.

Wool and Silk.
H. 5 ft.
W. 6 ft. 11 in.

Lent by Mrs.
William H. Crocker.

78 FLANDERS, LATE XVII CENTURY

THE CABRIOLE: *A young knight shows his skill in jumping his horse. At the left a page leads in a sumptuously caparisoned horse. At the right a large fountain is seen through the trees, and in the background is a formal garden with fountains.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 11 ft. 8 in.
W. 15 ft.

Lent by Mrs.
William H. Crocker.

Such very decorative verdures, half realistic landscapes, were among the finest products of the late XVIIth and XVIIIth centuries. Audenarde looms wove many of the best pieces of the type, and this piece probably came from that district. The fountain is rendered with delightful detail and animation, and the drawing of flowing waters, a trying problem for tapestry, is managed with admirable dexterity.

79 ANTWERP, LATE XVII CENTURY

SCENES FROM THE CHILDHOOD OF CHRIST: *On a black ground strewn with flowers, five oval panels framed with wreaths: the Annunciation; the Nativity; the Adoration of the Magi; the Circumcision; the Flight into Egypt.*

Wool and Silk.
H. 32 in.
W. 24 in.

Illustrated: Schmitz,
Bild-Teppiche, p.
265.

Lent by Mrs.
William H. Crocker.

This very unusual tapestry was the work of Balthasar Bosmanns, one of the greatest weavers of Antwerp. The realistically drawn yet richly decorative flowers show the influence of the school of flower painters of which Jan Brueghel was the most famous. The landscape in the *Adoration* and the *Flight into Egypt* are rendered with exquisite delicacy. The effect of the panels in such light, fresh, almost pastel colors against the black ground is a daring and striking decorative experiment. Another rendering of the same cartoon is in the Kunstgewerbe Museum, Berlin.

FOOTNOTES:

- [1] Schmitz, *Bild-Teppiche*, p. 186.
- [2] Lindner, *Der Breslauer Froissart*.
- [3] *Amberger Catalogue*.
- [4] Thiéry, *Les Inscriptions des Tapisseries de Jean Van Room*, pp. 23, 24E.
- [5] Marquet de Vasselot, *Les Emaux Limousin*, No. 8, pl. II.
- [6] *Op. cit.* 29, pl. X.
- [7] *Op. cit.* 49, pl. XVI.
- [8] *Order for Payment of Philip the Good, April 4, 1455, quoted in Van den Gheyn, Chroniques et Conquêtes de Charlemagne, by le Tavernier*, p. 11.
- [9] See *Burlington Magazine*, vol. 20, pp. 247, 309. D. T. B. Wood, *Credo Tapestries*.
- [10] See Barbier de Montault's inventory in *Annales Archéologiques*, tome 15, pp. 232, 296.
- [11] Van Kalcken, *Peintures ecclésiastiques du Moyen Age. Notes by Dr. Jan Six*.
- [12] *Op. cit.* p. 1.
- [13] *Op. cit.* p. 3.
- [14] *Op. cit.* p. 15.
- [15] *Burlington Magazine*, vol. 20, p. 220. D. T. B. Wood, *Tapestries of the Seven Deadly Sins*.
- [16] *Catalogue of the Collection of Martin le Roy*, vol. 4.
- [17] *Destrée, Tapisseries et Sculptures bruxelloises*, p. 8.
- [18] Thiéry, *Les Inscriptions des Tapisseries de Jean Van Room*.
- [19] Bodenhauser, *Gerard David*, No. 10.
- [20] *Op. cit.* No. 25a.
- [21] *Destrée, Hugo Van der Goes*, opp. p. 48.
- [22] *Op. cit.*, opp. p. 32.
- [23] Thiéry, *Les Inscriptions des Tapisseries de Jean Van Room*, p. 28.
- [24] Thiéry, *Les Inscriptions des Tapisseries de Jean Van Room*, p. 27. Also, *Destrée and Van den Ven, Les Tapisseries*, No. 17.
- [25] For illustration, see *Fsoulke Collection*, opp. p. 49.
- [26] Thomson, *History of Tapestry*, p. 479.
- [27] For further discussion, see *Gazette des Beaux Arts*, 2me Période; *Montaignon, Diane de Poitiers et Son Goût dans les Arts*, t. XIX, p. 152.
- [28] *La Renaissance de l'Art français*, 1921, p. 159 ff.; E. Dimier, *La Tenture de la Grande Galerie*.
- [29] Fénaille, *Etat général des Tapisseries de la Manufacture des Gobelins, Période Louis XIV*, pp. 337, 341f., 344, 370.

[30] *Fénaille, Etat général des Tapisseries de la Manufacture des Gobelins, Période Louis XIV*, pp. 337. 343f., 369.

[31] *Badin, La Manufacture de la Tapisserie de Beauvais*, p. 11.

[32] *Fénaille, Etat général des Tapisseries de la Manufacture des Gobelins, Dix-huitième Siècle*, Partie 11, p. 40ff.

[33] *Badin, La Manufacture de la Tapisserie de Beauvais*, p. 64.

[34] *Badin, La Manufacture de la Tapisserie de Beauvais*, p. 75.

A LIST OF WEAVERS

The following is a list of the most prominent weavers. Such men as Sir Francis Crane, of Mortlake, and Delorme, of Fontainebleau, have not been included because they were only administrators. It is possible that Grenier was not a weaver, though he may have been both weaver and contractor.

Nicolas Bataille	Paris	XIVth Century
Pasquier Grenier	Tournai	Middle of XVth Century
Pieter Van Aelst	Brussels	XVIth Century
Wilhelm Pannemaker	Brussels	XVIth Century
François Geubels	Brussels	XVIth Century
Hubert de Mecht	Brussels	XVIth Century
John Karcher	Ferrara	XVIth Century
Nicolas Karcher	Ferrara	XVIth Century
John Rost	Florence	XVIth Century
Philip de Mecht	Mortlake	XVIIth Century
Francis Poyntz	Mortlake	XVIIth Century
Francis Spierinx	Delft	XVIIth Century
John Vanderbanc	England	XVIIth Century
Catherine Van der Eynde	Brussels	XVIIth Century
Jean Raes	Brussels	XVIIth Century
Everard Leyniers	Brussels	XVIIth Century
Jacques Van der Beurcht	Brussels	XVIIth Century
Marc Comans	Paris	XVIIth Century
François de la Planche	Paris	XVIIth Century
Jean Lefévre	Paris	XVIIth Century

Jean Jans	Paris	XVIIth Century
Gerard Laurent	Paris	XVIIth Century
Philippe Behagle	Beauvais	XVIIIth Century
Cozette	Gobelins	XVIIIth Century
Le Blond	Gobelins	XVIIIth Century
De la Tour	Gobelins	XVIIIth Century
James Neilson	Gobelins	XVIIIth Century
Jacques Van der Goten	Madrid	XVIIIth Century
Antoine Lenger	Madrid	XVIIIth Century

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All the books starred () may be consulted in the
San Francisco Public Library*



There is, unfortunately, no satisfactory book in English on Tapestry and no wholly satisfactory book for the general reader in any language. The following are the most useful and are readily available.

**Candee, Helen Churchill. The Tapestry Book. New York, 1912.*

A somewhat superficial and sentimental sketch of the history of tapestry, with almost no interpretation and little indication of the relation of tapestry to the other arts.

DeMotte, G. J. Les Tapisseries gothiques. Paris, 1922.

When complete will contain two hundred large color plates of incomparable beauty and fidelity. Invaluable as a source-book. Will contain probably the majority of important examples of the period.

Guiffrey, J. J. L'Histoire de la Tapisserie. Tours, 1886.

A narrative history, now superseded in a number of respects.

Guiffrey, J. J. L'Histoire de la Tapisserie en France (L'Histoire générale de la Tapisserie). Paris, 1878-85.

A compilation of all the facts available at the time, and still an important fundamental reference work.

Guiffrey, J. J. Les Tapisseries du XIIIe à la fin du XVIe Siècle. Paris, n. d.

The most detailed survey of the period, but unfortunately poorly organized. Superbly illustrated.

*Hunter, George Leland. *Tapestries: Their Origin, History, and Renaissance*. New York, 1912.

An unsystematic assemblage of facts, not all of which are correct, and many of which are irrelevant.

Migeon, Gaston. *Les Arts de Tissue (Troisième Partie)*. Paris, 1909.

A complete and readable account of the history of tapestry, with some excellent interpretations.

Müntz, Eugène. *L'Histoire de la Tapisserie en Italie, en Allemagne, etc. (L'Histoire générale de la Tapisserie)*. Paris, 1878-85.

Similar to Guiffrey's volume in the same series.

Müntz, Eugène. *La Tapisserie*. Paris, 1883.

A brief presentation of the general history, superseded at some points, but with valuable illuminating interpretations.

Pinchart, A. *L'Histoire de la Tapisserie dans les Flandres (L'Histoire générale de la Tapisserie)*. Paris, 1878-85.

Similar to the other volumes of the same series.

Schmitz, Herman. *Bild-Teppiche*. Berlin, 1919.

By far the most systematic, scholarly, complete, and informing book yet published on the subject.

*Thomson, W. G. *A History of Tapestry*. New York, 1906.

A conventional history with useful tables of marks, but limited by being illustrated entirely with examples in England.

**Thomson, W. G. Tapestry Weaving in England. New York, 1914.*

The fundamental reference on this aspect of the subject, with full reproduction of documents.

In addition to the above titles, there are a great number of monographs on various phases of the subject, many of which are excellent. For example: *Thièry, Les Inscriptions des Tapisseries de Jean Van Room, Louvain, 1907*, is an able piece of work, a model of exact scholarship. The majority of these monographs are of interest only to the special student. Schmitz refers to the more important of them in his foot-notes.

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Every tapestry is listed by its respective catalogue number, and a star () indicates the tapestry is illustrated.*



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EDWARD DE WITT & HENRY H. TAYLOR
SAN FRANCISCO
1922

Transcriber Notes:

P. [20](#). 'the minature' changed to 'the miniature'.

Footnote p. [31](#). 'Chroniques et Conquêtes de Charlemaine' changed to 'Chroniques et Conquêtes Charlemagne'.

P. [60](#). 'Les Incrptions' changed to 'Les Inscriptions'.

Corrected various punctuation.

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